

WHITE SPARROW FARMACY

CONVERSION RATE OPTIMIZATION AUDIT

Prepared for: **Richard Mason** · whitesparrow.com

Package: Premium — Full Site Audit

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Hi Richard,

Thank you for trusting CRO Pro with this audit. I've spent time going through your site, your order brief, and the conversation we had before getting started — and I want to be upfront with you right from the beginning: I found some important things that go well beyond typical CRO recommendations.

Your site is genuinely beautiful. The brand feels warm and authentic. Your products are unique. And your 6% conversion rate tells me people who find you actually want what you're selling. That's a strong foundation to build on.

But there are a few things holding you back that we need to address honestly before we get into recommendations.

The Rebrand Did More Damage Than You May Realize

You mentioned that your ROAS tanked around the same time Meta updated its algorithm — and you're right that Meta made significant changes. But based on everything I can see, the bigger issue was the rebrand itself.

When you changed your website URL and domain, Meta's pixel — the tracking code that learns who your customers are — lost continuity. The history it had built over months of running \$15,000 in monthly ads was tied to the old domain. On the new one, it started from scratch. Meta's system needs a minimum of 50 purchase events per week to exit what's called the "learning phase." During that phase, your costs go up and your ROAS looks terrible. That's not failure — that's the cost of rebuilding.

The trouble is, the timing made it look like the algorithm update was the problem. So rather than waiting out the rebuild, you pulled the ads. That was the right instinct given what you knew — but it means the pixel stopped accumulating data again. When you turn ads back on, you'll be restarting from a cold pixel for the second time.

The good news: this is very fixable. But how you restart matters enormously, and we'll walk through exactly how to do it in the next section.

Your Site Has Expanded Beyond Skincare

When I visited whitesparrow.com, I noticed something your intake form didn't fully capture: you're no longer running a skincare store. You're running three distinct businesses from the same homepage — your tallow skincare line, a Pioneer Pantry food section, and a Heritage Nightgowns collection with pieces priced at \$176 each.

This matters for your Meta ads. The pixel Meta was training to find tallow skincare buyers was sending cold traffic to a homepage that now also shows nightgowns and pantry goods. Even if the pixel had survived the domain change, the audience signal would have gotten muddier. Meta's algorithm is trying to figure out who converts on your site, and your site is showing it three completely different product types.

We'll address how to structure this — both on the site and in your ads strategy — throughout the audit.

What This Document Covers

This audit covers your entire website — every major page and the full purchase funnel. Here's what you'll find inside:

- How to Exit the Meta Ads Learning Phase Fast — your action guide for restarting ads the right way
- Color and Contrast — 30 failing elements found and every fix documented
- Navigation — dropdown behavior, wrong links, mega menu recommendation
- Homepage — hero, trust signals, product sections, FAQ accordion
- Collection and Product Pages — copy, images, bundle presentation, mobile checkout
- Why Tallow, About Us, FAQ, Blog, Contact, and Wholesale pages — every page covered
- Meta Ads Strategy — how to rebuild your ROAS after the rebrand
- 30/60/90 Day Action Plan — prioritized by impact

Every recommendation is written in plain language. If something needs to change, I'll tell you what it should say, what it should look like, and why it matters.

Let's get your ROAS back.

David Aitken

CRO Pro

thecropro.com

HOW TO EXIT THE META ADS LEARNING PHASE FAST

Before we talk about your site, we need to talk about what happens when you turn your Meta ads back on — because the way you restart matters as much as any site improvement you make.

This section is your practical playbook for rebuilding Meta performance from the ground up. It's based on current 2026 Meta best practices and is written specifically for your situation.

What the Learning Phase Actually Is

The Meta learning phase is not a waiting period. It's a live calibration process where Meta's algorithm figures out who converts on your site, at what time of day, on which placements, and at what price. Until it has enough data to build a reliable model, it over-spends on exploration — your costs are high, your results are inconsistent, and your ROAS looks terrible.

That's not failure. That's the cost of entry.

The threshold is 50 purchase events per week, per ad set. Hit that number consistently and the algorithm exits learning and enters stable, efficient delivery. Miss it — because your budget is too low, your audience is too small, or you keep editing the campaign — and you stay stuck in learning indefinitely.

Your situation: when you changed your domain during the rebrand, Meta's pixel lost its conversion history. The tracking cookies that connect ad clicks to purchases are domain-specific. On the new domain, Meta started over. Then when you paused the ads, the algorithm stopped building new signal entirely. When you restart, you will be starting from a cold pixel — not picking up where you left off.

The 9 Things That Get You Through Learning Faster

1. **Match your budget to the math.** If your average cost per purchase is \$40 and you need 50 purchases per week, you need roughly \$280–\$400 per week per ad set just to meet the threshold. Too little budget and the algorithm is mathematically stuck — it can't collect enough signal. Run this calculation before you set any budget.
2. **Start with Add to Cart, not Purchase.** Because your pixel is cold, optimizing straight for Purchase means Meta has almost nothing to learn from. Add to Cart happens far more often than Purchase — start there. Let it exit learning on Add to Cart, then create a second campaign optimizing for Purchase. That second campaign will exit faster because the account signal is already warmer.
3. **Keep your campaign structure tight.** One campaign per objective. No more than 2–3 ad sets per campaign. No more than 3–5 creatives per ad set. Every extra ad set or creative spreads your conversion signal thinner, and every individual ad set takes longer to exit learning. Less is genuinely more here.
4. **Use Advantage+ Campaign Budget (CBO).** Let Meta allocate the budget across your ad sets dynamically instead of fixing it manually. This lets the algorithm push spend toward whichever ad set is generating the strongest signal fastest — one of the single most impactful structural changes you can make on restart.

5. **Use Advantage+ Audience — go broad.** Do not manually stack interest layers or demographic restrictions. Meta's AI finds your buyer better than any manual targeting you can build. Broad Advantage+ targeting exits the learning phase faster than narrow targeting because it gives Meta more room to explore your actual converter profile.
6. **Lead with strong video creative.** Creative quality is now an audience signal. Short-form video (15–30 seconds) generates the densest signal because video completion rates, 3-second views, and engagement data all feed the algorithm. The hook — the first 3 seconds — is everything. Invest in strong video before you restart spending.
7. **Set a hard 7-day no-touch window.** Once the campaign is live, do not touch anything for at least 7 days. No budget changes, no creative swaps, no audience adjustments, no copy edits. Every significant edit resets the learning phase counter to zero. The volatility you see in the first few days is the algorithm exploring — not failing.
8. **Scale by 20% at a time, every 3–4 days.** Any budget increase above 20% in a single edit triggers a full learning phase reset. Once your campaign is performing, increase by 20% every 3–4 days. It feels slow, but it's the only reliable way to scale without restarting over and over.
9. **Verify your pixel before you spend a dollar.** Go to Meta Events Manager and confirm every event fires in the correct sequence: ViewContent → AddToCart → InitiateCheckout → Purchase. If these are misfiring, duplicating, or missing, the algorithm learns from bad data. You have Stape installed on your site — use it to set up Meta's Conversions API (CAPI). A properly configured CAPI setup recovers 20–40% of the conversions that browser-only tracking misses due to iOS privacy restrictions.

Your Restart Roadmap

When you're ready to turn the ads back on, follow this sequence in order:

Step	Action
Step 1	Verify your Meta pixel is firing correctly on the new domain. Check Events Manager. Fix any misfires before spending a single dollar.
Step 2	Set up Meta Conversions API (CAPI) via Stape. This recovers the conversion signal you're currently missing from iOS users.
Step 3	Launch one Advantage+ Shopping campaign optimizing for Add to Cart. One ad set. 3–4 creatives (short-form video first). At least \$50/day.
Step 4	Do not touch the campaign for 7 full days. Watch. Don't optimize.
Step 5	Once Add to Cart campaign shows Active status (learning complete), create a new campaign optimizing for Purchase.
Step 6	Scale the Purchase campaign by 20% every 3–4 days once ROAS is stable and consistent.

Important: the site improvements in the rest of this audit — homepage, product pages, checkout, navigation — all need to be in place BEFORE you restart your ads. A well-optimized site is what turns Meta traffic into sales. Getting the pixel and campaign structure right is only half of it. Do both.

HOMEPAGE — COLOR & CONTRAST

Every text element on the site was tested against WCAG 2.1 AA standards — the internationally recognized benchmark for readable web content. AA requires a contrast ratio of 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large or bold text. The audit found 30 failing elements across five distinct problem areas. Here is what is failing and exactly what to change.

1. Hero Text — No Protection Over the Photo

The headline text sitting over the hero image has no dark overlay and no text shadow applied. Both are rendered in cream directly against the photo. In areas where the photo shows skin tones or light fabric, the cream text disappears entirely. This is the most important contrast fix on the site, because it affects every single visitor before they scroll.

Element	Text Color	Background	Ratio	Required	Result
"ALL NATURAL" (22px)	Cream #EDEAE0	Photo — unprotected	~1.0:1	3.0:1	FAIL
"TALLOW BALM COLLECTION" (40px)	Cream #EDEAE0	Photo — unprotected	~1.0:1	3.0:1	FAIL

Fix: In Shopify theme editor, add a background overlay at `rgba(0,0,0,0.20)` to the hero section. Alternatively, add CSS: `.hero__content { text-shadow: 0 1px 6px rgba(0,0,0,0.45); }` — this takes under five minutes and immediately makes the headline readable at every scroll position.

2. Shop Category Banners — Invisible CTAs

The three full-width category banners (Shop Farmacy, Shop Pioneer Pantry, Shop Nightgowns) each use cream text and a cream-bordered button over deliberately faded photo backgrounds. The photos are washed out by design, which means the cream buttons are effectively sitting on a near-white surface. These are primary navigation elements — they drive category clicks — and right now they are nearly invisible.

Element	Text Color	Background	Ratio	Required	Result
"SHOP FARMACY" (16px bold)	Cream #EDEAE0	Faded photo	~1.0:1	4.5:1	FAIL
"SHOP PIONEER PANTRY" (16px bold)	Cream #EDEAE0	Faded photo	~1.0:1	4.5:1	FAIL
"SHOP NIGHTGOWNS" (16px bold)	Cream #EDEAE0	Faded photo	~1.0:1	4.5:1	FAIL

Fix: Change the button text and border color from cream to a dark charcoal (#3E3E3E) or deep olive. This will immediately read against the light faded backgrounds and maintains the vintage, earthy brand feel.

3. Footer — Every Single Link Fails

The footer uses cream text on a steel blue background. The measured contrast ratio is 3.57:1. For the 14–17px text throughout the footer, WCAG AA requires 4.5:1. Every text element in the footer fails — including all navigation links, policy links, social media links, and the copyright line. This is the single largest concentration of failing elements on the site.

Element	Size	Ratio	Required	Result
MENU / POLICIES / FOLLOW US headings	16px	3.57:1	4.5:1	FAIL
Shop All, Shop Tallow Balms, Why Tallow	17px	3.57:1	4.5:1	FAIL
Contact Us, Wholesale, FAQs, Affiliate Program	17px	3.57:1	4.5:1	FAIL
Return Policy, Terms of Service, Privacy Policy	17px	3.57:1	4.5:1	FAIL
INSTAGRAM, FACEBOOK social links	17px	3.57:1	4.5:1	FAIL
© 2026 White Sparrow Farmacy	14px	3.57:1	4.5:1	FAIL

Fix: Change footer text from cream (#EDEAE0) to pure white (#FFFFFF). The ratio immediately jumps to 5.14:1 — comfortably passing. One CSS line: footer a, footer p, footer h2 { color: #FFFFFF; }

4. Product Card "Collection" Badge & Hero CTA Button

The steel blue badge on product cards labeled "Collection" uses the same cream-on-steel-blue combination as the footer — 3.57:1 at 17px against a required 4.5:1. The primary "SHOP NOW" hero button measures 4.31:1 with cream text on olive green — a borderline fail on the single most important button on the homepage.

Fix (badge): Change the "Collection" badge text from cream to white (#FFFFFF) — likely covered by the same footer CSS rule.

Fix (button): Switch button text to pure white (#FFFFFF), bringing the ratio to approximately 6.1:1, or darken the olive background slightly from #6A714E to #5A6040.

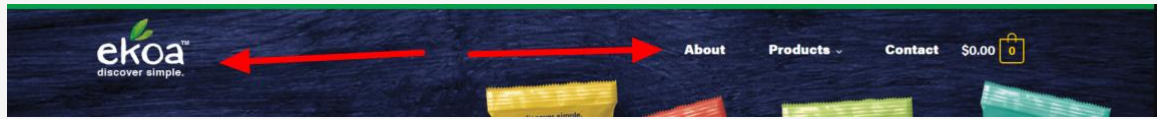
Summary — All Contrast Failures

Location	Issue	Ratio	Fix
Hero headline	Cream text on unprotected photo	~1.0:1	Add dark overlay or text-shadow

Category banners (3)	Cream text/border on faded photo	~1.0:1	Darken text to charcoal/olive
Footer — all text (15+ elements)	Cream on steel blue	3.57:1	Change text to white #FFFFFF
"Collection" product badge	Cream on steel blue	3.57:1	Change text to white #FFFFFF
"SHOP NOW" hero button	Cream on olive green	4.31:1	White text or darker button

None of these fixes require a developer or a theme rebuild. The hero overlay and footer color change are both achievable in Shopify's theme editor or with a small CSS snippet in the custom CSS field. The category banner buttons can be updated directly in section settings.

NAVIGATION



Example: clean, well-structured navigation with hover dropdown — a model for how your revised nav should look

Navigation is the invisible architecture of your site. When it works, visitors move toward a purchase without thinking about it. When it doesn't, they stall — they get confused, they miss categories entirely, or they give up and leave. Your navigation currently has four distinct problems, and I want to walk through each one carefully because together they're costing you a meaningful percentage of your potential sales.

Issue 1 — The "Shop" Dropdown Requires Two Separate Clicks

Here's what's happening right now: when a visitor clicks the word "Shop" in your main navigation, it sends them directly to your All Products page — a wall of every item you sell, completely unsorted. To see the subcategories (Tallow Balms, Lip Balms, Hair Oil, Cold Cream, and so on), they have to notice a separate down-arrow icon next to the word "Shop" and click that specifically.

The problem is that most visitors don't notice the arrow. It's a secondary element, visually smaller than the main navigation text, and most people's eyes go straight to the word. They click "Shop," land on everything at once, feel slightly overwhelmed by the variety, and either scroll aimlessly or leave. The subcategory architecture you've built is completely invisible to the majority of people who visit the site.

The fix is switching the trigger from click to hover. On desktop, hovering the mouse cursor over the word "Shop" should cause the dropdown to appear automatically — no click required. The visitor sees the subcategories while still on whatever page they were on, chooses the one that matches what they want, and clicks straight into that collection. Zero extra steps, zero confusion, zero wasted navigation attempts.

On mobile, hover doesn't exist — instead, tapping "Shop" should expand the subcategories in-place as an accordion list directly below the "Shop" item in the mobile menu. This is the standard mobile navigation pattern used by virtually every major e-commerce brand, and users expect it.

How to fix this: In most Shopify themes, this is a single toggle in the theme customizer under Navigation settings — look for a "Dropdown trigger" option and change it from "Click" to "Hover." If your theme doesn't have this toggle built in, it's a small CSS/JavaScript change that any developer can implement in under 30 minutes.

Test it yourself: after making the change, hover over "Shop" in a fresh browser window and confirm the subcategories appear. Then test on your phone and confirm tapping "Shop" expands the submenu rather than navigating away.

Issue 2 — Several Navigation Links Point to the Wrong Pages

During the audit I clicked through every link in your navigation dropdown and found that multiple items are sending customers to the wrong destinations. The most critical example is the Lip Balm Collection link — it currently points to /collections/apparel-jewelry, which is your clothing and accessories collection. A customer who clicks "Lip Balms" expecting to see lip balm products is instead taken to an apparel page. They will immediately assume something is broken and leave.

Beyond that specific error, several other dropdown items link to individual product pages rather than collection pages. This means customers who click a category name see a single product with no ability to browse the full range in that category. Someone looking for options gets one option and no obvious path forward.

These are navigation settings issues — they live in Shopify Admin, not in your theme code. No developer required. Each one is a five-minute fix.

Exact fix: Go to Shopify Admin → Navigation → Main Menu. Click each dropdown item and verify the URL it points to.

- Lip Balm Collection: change destination from /collections/apparel-jewelry to your correct lip balm collection URL (check Shopify Admin → Products → Collections to confirm the handle).
- Any item currently pointing to a /products/ URL: change to the corresponding /collections/ URL so customers can browse the full range.
- While you're in there: confirm every link in the dropdown goes where it says it goes. This entire review takes about 15 minutes.

Issue 3 — Breadcrumb Navigation Is Missing Sitewide

Every sub-page on your site — every product page, every collection page, the FAQ, About Us, Why Tallow, Contact, Wholesale — currently displays with no breadcrumb trail. A breadcrumb is the small navigation line you see at the top of sub-pages on well-built sites, typically reading something like: Home > Shop Tallow Balms > Tallow Balm Original. It tells visitors exactly where they are in your site hierarchy and gives them one-click access to any parent page without using the browser back button.

Why does this matter for conversion? Because a significant percentage of your traffic doesn't enter through the homepage. Customers who click a Facebook ad, find you on Google, or follow a link from a blog post land directly on a product page or collection page. Without a breadcrumb, those visitors have no immediate sense of how your site is structured, no easy path to explore related products, and no obvious way to navigate "up" to a collection if they want to see more options. Many of them just hit the back button and leave.

Breadcrumbs also help with SEO in two ways: they help Google understand your site's internal structure (which improves the quality of your index), and they can appear as part of your listing in Google Search results — the breadcrumb trail sometimes replaces the URL under your title, which makes your listing look more organized and improves click-through rate from search.

How to enable: Go to Shopify Admin → Online Store → Themes → Customize. Look in the product page settings and the collection page settings for a Breadcrumbs toggle — most Dawn-based and modern Shopify themes have this as a built-in option that simply needs to be turned on.

If your theme doesn't have a breadcrumbs toggle, search the Shopify App Store for "breadcrumbs" — free apps like Breadcrumbs NavXT add this site-wide without any coding.

After enabling, verify by visiting a product page and confirming the breadcrumb trail appears near the top, before the product title.

Issue 4 — Upgrade to a Mega Menu

Your current navigation shows a simple vertical list of links when the dropdown opens. For a store with multiple product categories and a rich brand story, a mega menu is a significant upgrade. A mega menu is a large, structured panel that appears on hover and organizes your navigation into a visual layout — subcategories in columns, a featured product or lifestyle image on the right, and optional promotional callouts. It lets visitors understand your full product range in a single glance, without clicking anything.

The best reference for what this can look like in your market is Counter.com — hover over any category like "Skin" or "Makeup" and you see the subcategory structure laid out in organized columns alongside a lifestyle image on the right. The visual context makes it feel less like a navigation list and more like a product discovery experience. Visitors understand the breadth of your range immediately.

For Shopify, two apps deliver this cleanly and are used by thousands of stores. Globo Mega Menu (4.9 stars, over 1,344 reviews in the App Store) has a visual drag-and-drop editor and supports images, multi-column layouts, and promotional banners. Qikify Mega Menu (4.9 stars, over 1,019 reviews) is equally capable and slightly simpler to configure. Both have free tiers or affordable monthly plans. Neither requires coding — installation is a standard Shopify app install and the setup is done in a visual editor.

Recommended mega menu layout:

LEFT COLUMN — Skincare

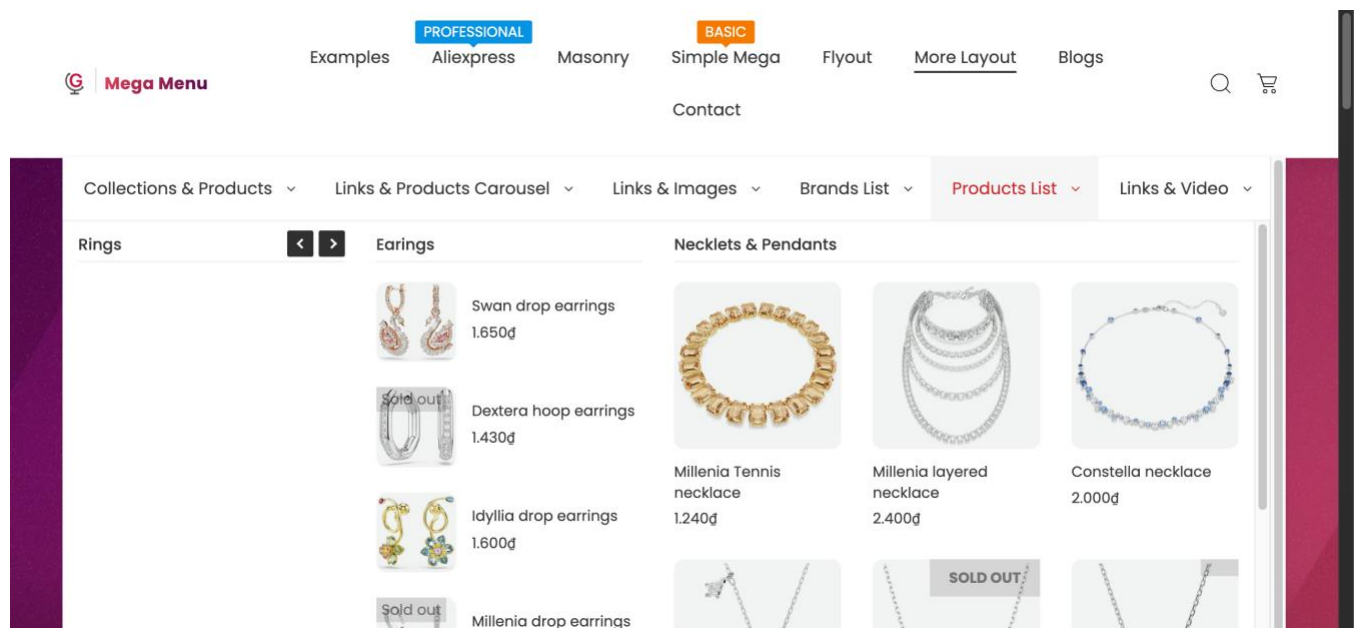
Tallow Balm Collection | Lip Balm Collection | Hair Oil | Cold Cream | Shop All Farmacy

MIDDLE COLUMN — More

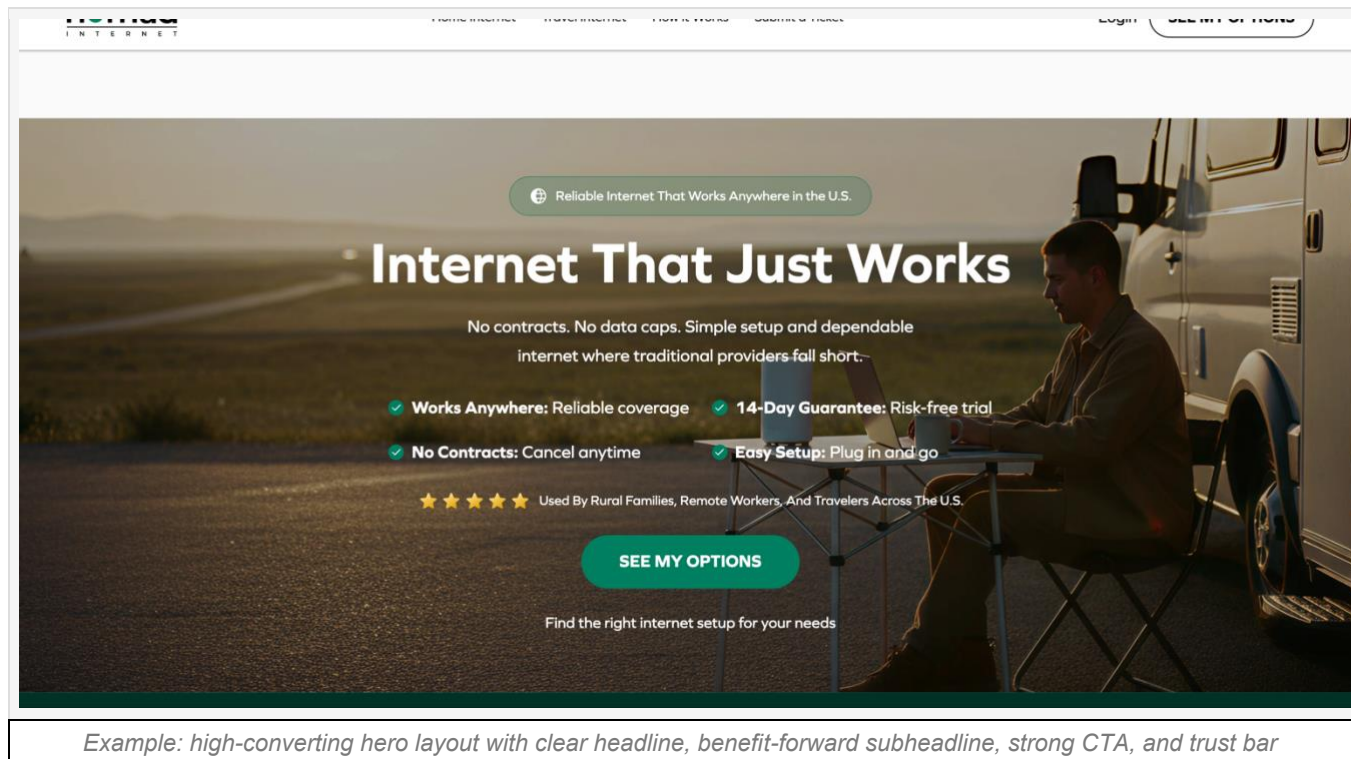
Pioneer Pantry | Heritage Nightgowns | About Us | Why Tallow

RIGHT PANEL — Lifestyle image of the tallow balm products on a natural surface, with a brief line: "Made on our farm. Good for your skin."

Desktop: hover "Shop" → panel opens. Mobile: tap "Shop" → accordion expands. No panel on mobile — just the structured list.



HOMEPAGE — HERO & ABOVE THE FOLD



The hero section is where your site makes its first impression — and for paid traffic, it's where most purchase decisions are effectively made or lost. Visitors who arrive from a Facebook or Instagram ad have already been through one decision point (clicking the ad). The hero's job is to immediately confirm that clicking was the right choice: to make them feel like they've arrived somewhere that understands what they were looking for. When that confirmation doesn't happen fast enough, they bounce.

Your hero does some things well. The full-width lifestyle photography is warm and emotionally appropriate for the brand. The "ALL NATURAL" and "TALLOW BALM COLLECTION" text communicates the product category. The "SHOP NOW" button is visible above the fold. But there are several things holding it back from performing at the level it could — and they're all fixable.

The Core Problem: No Message Match for Paid Traffic

When someone clicks your Facebook ad, they responded to a specific hook — a headline, an image, a promise. That's called ad scent. The hero section's job is to continue that exact scent: if the ad said "for sensitive skin," the hero should lead with sensitive skin. If the ad said "grass-fed, family farm," the hero should say grass-fed and family farm right up front. If the hero says something different from what the ad said, visitors experience a scent break — a moment of "wait, is this the right site?" — and a percentage of them leave immediately.

Right now your hero uses the same copy regardless of where the visitor came from. A customer who clicked an ad about tallow for eczema lands on the same hero as someone who typed "natural moisturizer" into Google. One of those visitors is seeing exactly what they expect. The other feels a subtle disconnect. Paid traffic that converts at homepage level — rather than on dedicated landing pages — is particularly sensitive to this.

The solution is two-pronged. For your homepage — which serves organic, direct, and returning visitors — update the hero copy to be direct and benefit-forward. For paid traffic, build dedicated landing pages

(covered in the Meta Ads section) that match each ad's specific message. The homepage serves everyone. The landing pages serve the ad-specific audience with perfect scent continuity.

Proposed Hero Copy

The current headline is soft. It communicates what the product is but doesn't communicate why it matters to the person standing in front of it. Here's what I'd recommend instead:

HEADLINE: Real ingredients. Real results.

SUBHEADLINE: 100% grass-fed tallow skincare made on a family farm in Idaho. No fillers, no synthetics — just what your skin actually needs.

CTA BUTTON: Shop Tallow Balms

BELOW CTA (small trust text): Free shipping on orders over \$75 · 4.9 stars · Loved by 2,000+ customers

WHY THIS WORKS: "Real ingredients. Real results." is a direct response to the biggest objection in the clean beauty market — skepticism about whether "natural" products actually work. It also implicitly contrasts with synthetic competitors without naming them. The subheadline grounds the brand in specificity (grass-fed, family farm, Idaho) which builds credibility and differentiation.

Proposed Hero Copy — Paid Traffic Landing Page (Skin Sensitivity Angle)

HEADLINE: Finally — a moisturizer that doesn't break you out.

SUBHEADLINE: Our tallow balm is made from one grass-fed ingredient your skin already recognizes. No parabens, no fillers, no fragrance. Just skin that finally feels like yours again.

CTA BUTTON: Try the Tallow Balm — Subscribe & Save 15%

SOCIAL PROOF BELOW CTA: "I've tried everything for my sensitive skin. This is the first moisturizer that didn't make it worse — it made it better." — Verified Customer, 5 stars

This landing page strips out the main navigation menu and footer links. The only path forward is the CTA.

Proposed Hero Copy — Paid Traffic Landing Page (Grass-Fed / Family Farm Angle)

HEADLINE: One ingredient you can actually pronounce. One moisturizer your skin has been asking for.

SUBHEADLINE: White Sparrow Farmacy makes 100% grass-fed tallow skincare on our family farm in Idaho. Small-batch, clean-label, and built for people who read ingredient labels.

CTA BUTTON: Shop the Collection

TRUST BAR BELOW CTA: [Grass icon] 100% Grass-Fed | [Farm icon] Idaho Family Farm | [Star icon] 4.9 Stars | [Shield icon] No Fillers

Add a Trust Bar Below the Hero CTA

Directly below the "SHOP NOW" button on the homepage hero, add a horizontal row of four small icon blocks. These are known as a trust bar, and they do the most important conversion work on the page: they answer the question every first-time visitor has, which is "why should I trust this brand?" before they even read a word of product copy.

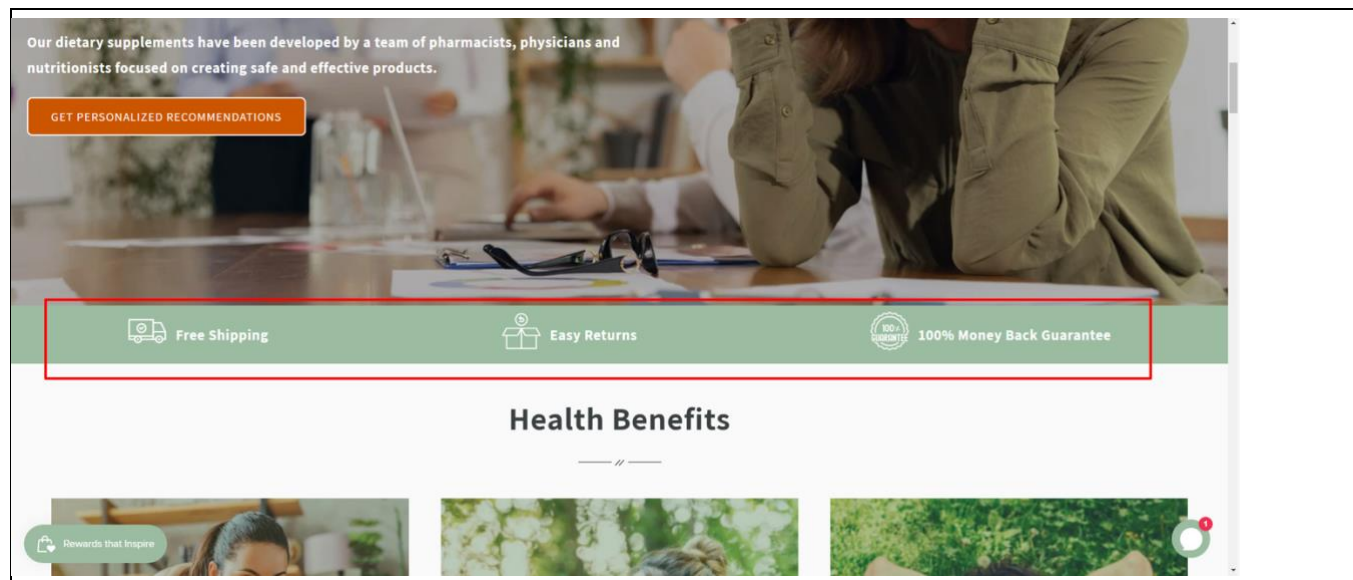
Each block is simple — a small icon above a two-to-three word bold label. Here's exactly what to use and why each one was chosen:

- Icon: grass/leaf — Label: "100% Grass-Fed" — Why: this differentiates immediately from commodity tallow and signals quality sourcing. It's your most important ingredient story.
- Icon: barn or farmhouse — Label: "Family Farm, Idaho" — Why: provenance is a major trust signal for natural beauty customers. Specific geography (Idaho, not "a farm") feels more real and less marketing.
- Icon: five-pointed star — Label: "4.9 Star Reviews" — Why: social proof near the CTA reduces the perceived risk of the first purchase. 4.9 is an exceptionally high average — it deserves prominence.
- Icon: shield or checkmark — Label: "No Fillers, Ever" — Why: this directly addresses the #1 concern of your target customer (synthetic ingredients hiding in "natural" products). The word "Ever" adds conviction.

On desktop, these four blocks sit in a single horizontal row immediately below the hero CTA button, still above the fold at standard laptop screen heights. On mobile, they stack into a 2x2 grid below the CTA. Each icon should be simple and line-art style — not photographic, not colorful — so they read clearly at small sizes and don't compete with the hero photography.



Example: a well-executed trust bar with icon + label format — positioned directly below the hero CTA



Desktop vs. Mobile Hero Strategy

On desktop, the hero runs at full viewport height — the lifestyle photo fills the screen, the headline and subheadline are visible in the upper portion of the image with the text overlay fix applied (see Color & Contrast section), and the CTA and trust bar are visible without any scrolling. The visual emphasis is on the photography with the text providing context and the button providing action.

On mobile, the hero needs specific adjustments. The headline must be minimum 28px — anything smaller requires the visitor to zoom to read it, and most won't. The CTA button should be full-width across the phone screen and large enough to tap comfortably with a thumb — minimum 44px height, ideally 54-60px. The subheadline can be slightly smaller to fit below the headline without requiring scrolling to reach the button. The trust bar on mobile should stack into a 2x2 grid below the CTA, with each icon block full-width for its column.

A quick test: pull up your homepage on your own phone and try to tap the "SHOP NOW" button with your thumb without looking directly at it. If you miss it, the button is too small.

HOMEPAGE — BELOW THE FOLD

Once a visitor scrolls past the hero, your homepage has about three to four seconds to give them a reason to keep moving toward a product. The below-the-fold content on your homepage currently includes a featured products block, three category banners, a reviews carousel, and a footer. Here's what's working, what isn't, and what to add.

Featured Products — Pre-Select Subscribe & Save

Your homepage features the Tallow Balm products with an Add to Cart option. This is strategically correct — bringing the purchase option to the homepage means visitors don't need to navigate to a product page to start buying, and that reduces friction significantly. However, there's a major missed opportunity in how the purchase options are presented.

The Subscribe & Save toggle is currently unselected by default. It sits below the one-time purchase option as a secondary choice. From a conversion standpoint this is the wrong framing. Subscribe & Save should be the default selected state — pre-ticked, with the discounted first-order price displayed prominently as the "price" the visitor sees.

Here's the psychology of why this matters: when a visitor sees \$30.60 as the price (reflecting a 15% subscribe-and-save discount on a \$36 balm), their mental reference point for this product is thirty dollars. If they decide to switch to a one-time purchase, they watch the price go up to \$36 — and that feels like they're paying extra, not that they're making a choice. Subscription feels like the reward, one-time purchase feels like missing out. That's the exact opposite of how it works when one-time purchase is the default.

The same logic applies to quantity. Pre-select the "Two Balms" option by default. The two-pack brings the order to \$72 with the subscription discount — close to your \$75 free shipping threshold, and a meaningfully higher average order value. Customers who genuinely only want one can deselect. Most won't change anything.

This is a Shopify theme code edit — specifically, setting the default selected state for the subscription radio button and the quantity variant selector. A Shopify developer can implement both in under one hour. This is one of the highest direct-revenue changes in this entire audit.

Apply the same change to every product page on the site — not just the homepage featured product. See the Product Page Template section.

The Free Shipping Threshold Gap

Your free shipping threshold is \$75. Your flagship product costs \$36. That's a \$39 gap between the most natural first purchase and free shipping — meaning a first-time customer who adds one Tallow Balm to cart needs to spend more than double their initial purchase to qualify.

When customers reach the cart and see "add \$39 more for free shipping," a significant percentage of them abandon rather than add something they weren't planning to buy. The ones who do add something often feel coerced, which is a negative brand experience even if it increases that particular order value.

Two options to address this. Option one: lower the threshold to \$60. At \$60, the "two balms" bundle with subscription discount (\$60.80) crosses the threshold naturally, and the free shipping bar in the cart becomes a gentle, achievable nudge rather than a difficult ask. Option two: leave the threshold at \$75 but make the path to it clearer and more rewarding — present the bundle more prominently, make

the free shipping progress bar visible during browsing (not just in the cart), and frame reaching the threshold as a win rather than a requirement.

The Three-Business Problem on Category Banners

Your homepage features three large category banners side by side: Shop Farmacy, Shop Pioneer Pantry, and Shop Nightgowns. Presented equally as three large banners, these signal to a first-time visitor that your site is three separate businesses that happen to share a homepage. That creates a moment of confusion — "what IS this store?" — at precisely the moment you need clarity.

For a customer who clicked a Facebook ad for tallow skincare, arriving at a page that prominently features nightgowns and pantry goods creates an ad scent break. The homepage feels like the wrong place, even if the product they came for is right there. For a returning skincare customer, the nightgown banner feels irrelevant. For a customer who wants nightgowns, the tallow balm banner feels irrelevant.

The longer-term solution is to give each product line its own destination — either separate landing pages for paid traffic, or a clearer visual hierarchy where Farmacy is the primary focus and Pioneer Pantry and Nightgowns are secondary. For now, the minimum viable fix is reordering the banners so the Farmacy (skincare) banner appears first and most prominently, and making the visual size differential clear enough that visitors immediately understand which category is the main product line.



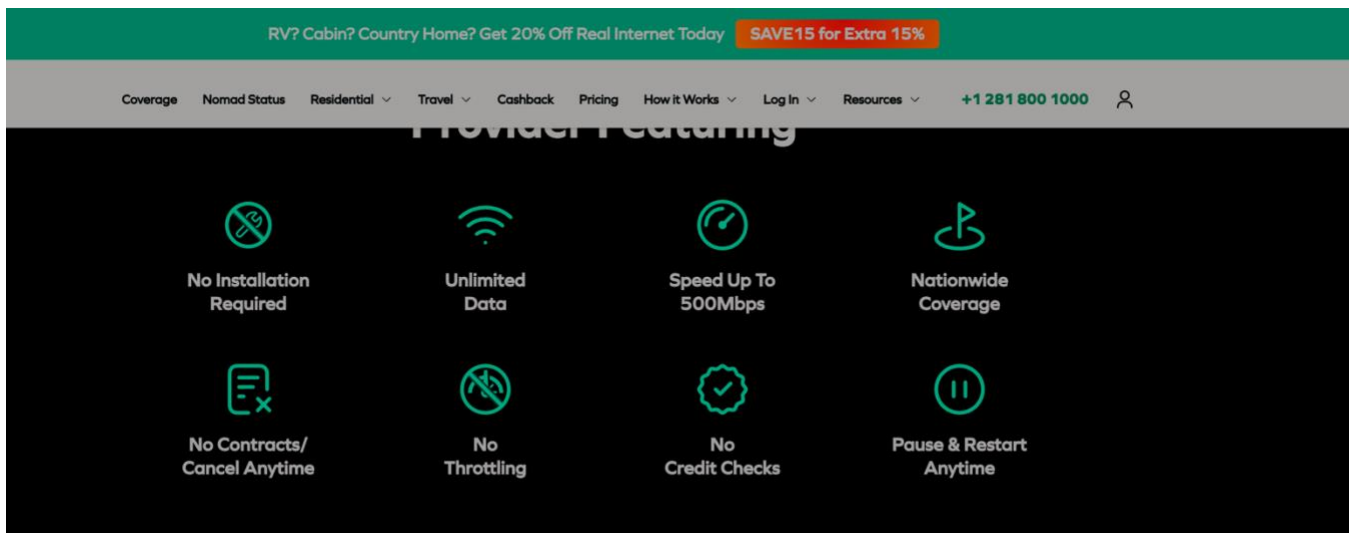
Add a Benefit Icon Grid Between the Hero and Products

Between the hero section and the featured products, add a horizontal row of four icon blocks. This is a benefit grid — a compact, visual summary of your brand's core value propositions. It takes up very little vertical space but does critical work: it gives visitors who are still on the fence about whether to engage with your products a clear, fast answer to "why this brand?"

The four recommended blocks for the homepage version of this grid are:

- Icon: grass or leaf symbol — Bold label: "Grass-Fed Tallow" — Supporting line (smaller text, one sentence): Sourced from 100% grass-fed cattle on our family farm in Idaho.
- Icon: shield or clean leaf — Bold label: "No Fillers" — Supporting line: Every product is clean-label. No parabens, no synthetics, no ingredients you can't pronounce.
- Icon: barn or farmhouse — Bold label: "Family Farm" — Supporting line: Made in small batches on the Mason family farm. Not outsourced. Not mass-produced.
- Icon: five-pointed star — Bold label: "4.9 Stars" — Supporting line: Hundreds of verified reviews from real customers with real results.

On desktop this renders as a single horizontal row of four equal-width columns, each 180-220px wide, centered on the page. On mobile it collapses to a 2x2 grid — two icons per row, two rows. The icon itself should be simple line art, about 40-50px tall, in your olive or charcoal brand colors. The bold label sits below the icon, and the supporting sentence sits below that in a lighter weight.



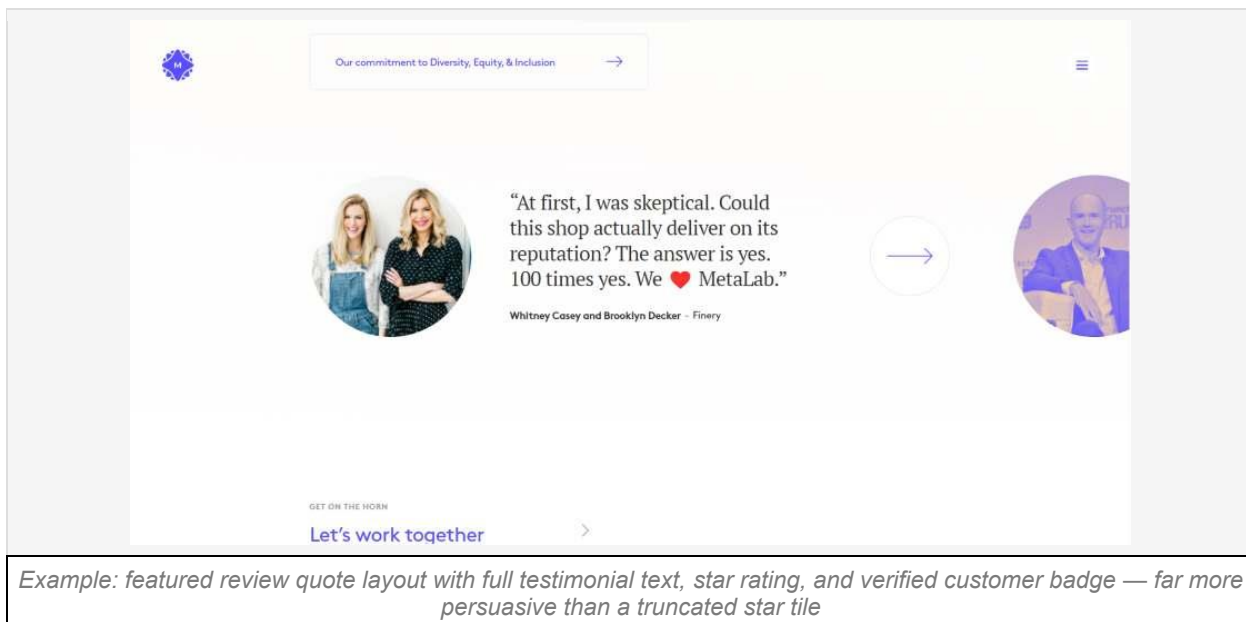
Reviews Section — Feature Full Quotes

Your Yotpo review carousel is present and shows your 4.9-star average — that's a strong trust signal. One improvement that will meaningfully increase its persuasive power: feature one or two complete review quotes prominently before the carousel begins, rather than jumping straight to the star-rating tiles.

A complete quote that describes a specific problem solved — eczema that cleared up, dry hands that finally healed, sensitive skin that stopped reacting — is more persuasive than a 5-star rating with a short truncated preview. The best review quotes tell a story that a prospective customer can see themselves in. Pull your two strongest full-text reviews and give them featured placement above the carousel, in a large-font callout style. Something like:

"I've had eczema my whole life and have tried every 'natural' moisturizer on the market. This is the first one that didn't make my skin angrier. Two weeks in and my hands look completely different." — Sarah M., Verified Customer ★★★★★

"My daughter has super sensitive skin and breaks out from everything. We've been using the tallow balm for a month and her skin is the clearest it's been in years. I'm not exaggerating." — Jennifer K., Verified Customer ★★★★★



Homepage FAQ Accordion — Add This Above the Footer

Add a five-question FAQ accordion section in the lower portion of the homepage, above the footer. The accordion format means all five questions are visible as collapsed headers — the page doesn't look like a text wall — and each question expands on click to show the answer. This serves two distinct purposes.

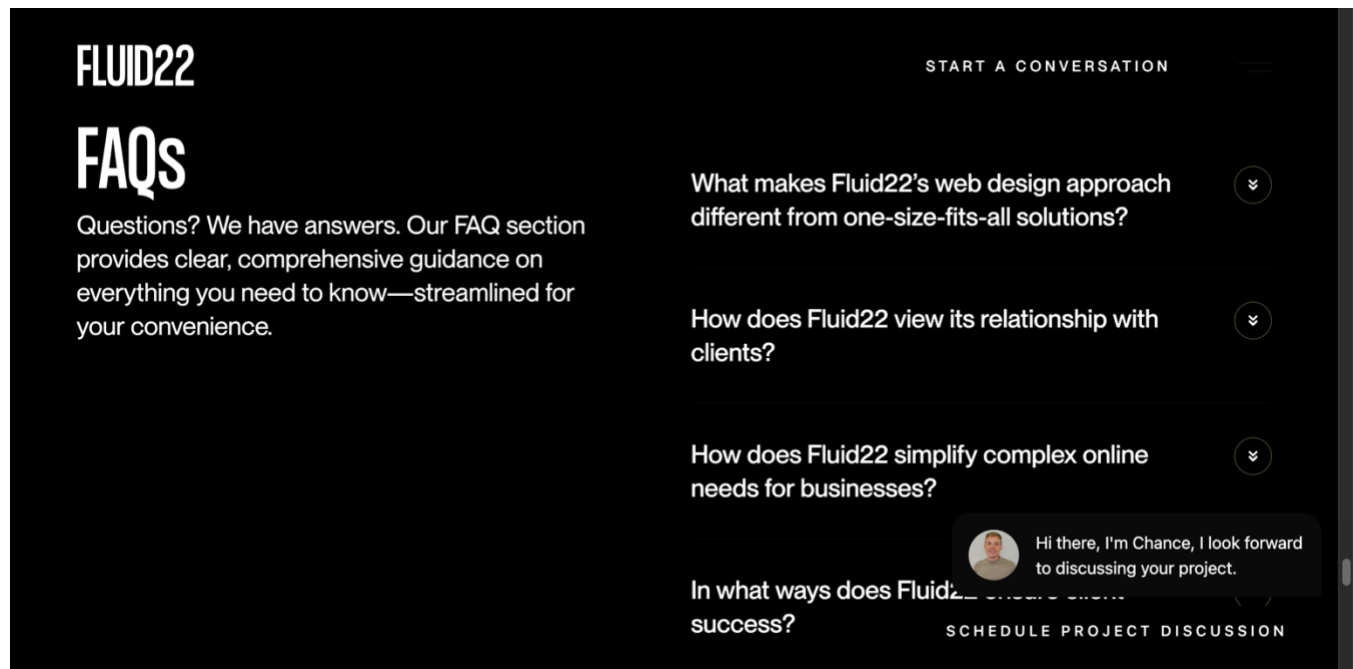
First, conversion: pre-purchase objections are one of the primary causes of cart abandonment, and your most common pre-purchase questions are almost certainly about what tallow is, whether it's safe for sensitive skin, where it comes from, and how it compares to conventional moisturizers. Answering those questions on the homepage — before the visitor ever has to look for them — removes the last layer of hesitation for a meaningful percentage of visitors.

Second, SEO: all content inside collapsed accordions is fully readable by Google's crawlers. The FAQ content adds keyword-rich prose to your homepage — terms like "grass-fed tallow for sensitive skin," "tallow balm vs moisturizer," "natural ingredients skincare" — without making the page look cluttered or overwhelming to human visitors.

Recommended five questions for the homepage FAQ:

- What is tallow balm and why is it good for skin? — Answer should explain what beef tallow is, why grass-fed sourcing matters, and how its fatty acid profile makes it highly compatible with skin.
- Is tallow balm safe for sensitive skin and the face? — Answer should address the fragrance-free, additive-free formulation and mention that many eczema and rosacea customers have found it gentler than conventional moisturizers.
- What's the difference between your Tallow Balm and a regular moisturizer? — Answer should contrast the single-ingredient approach with conventional moisturizers that use water, emulsifiers, and synthetic preservatives.
- Where does your tallow come from? — Answer should name the family farm, mention Idaho, and reinforce the small-batch, traceable sourcing story.
- How long does one jar last? — Answer should give a realistic estimate (most customers get 2-3 months from a single jar) and mention that a little goes a long way due to the concentration of the formula.

End the FAQ section with a "See all FAQs" link that routes to the full FAQ page. This creates an internal link between your homepage and your FAQ page, which is good for site structure, and it gives visitors who have more questions a clear next step.



COLLECTION PAGE TEMPLATE

This section applies to all of your collection pages — Shop Tallow Balms, Shop Lip Balms, Shop Hair Oil, Pioneer Pantry, Heritage Nightgowns, and any future collection you create. Collection pages are often the most overlooked part of a Shopify store's conversion optimization. Most store owners put all their effort into product pages and forget that the collection page is where browsers become buyers — it's where a visitor who's interested but undecided decides whether to click through to a product at all.

Add a Collection Description at the Top

Your collection pages currently display the product grid with no introductory copy. There's no context, no reason to care, no differentiation from every other skincare brand that has a collection page. Adding two to three sentences at the very top of the collection — before the product grid — does two things simultaneously.

For visitors, it provides the emotional context they need to feel engaged before they start scrolling products. For Google, it provides keyword-rich prose content on the collection page that helps rank for broader category search terms ("grass-fed tallow balm," "natural face moisturizer," "clean skincare Idaho").

Proposed collection description for the Tallow Balms collection:

Our tallow balms start with one ingredient — 100% grass-fed beef tallow from our family farm in Idaho — and build from there. No synthetic emulsifiers, no petroleum-based fillers, no fragrance. Just the most skin-compatible moisturizer nature makes, in a formula your skin actually recognizes.

If you have dry, sensitive, or reactive skin and you've tried everything else, this is where most of our customers start.

Proposed collection description for the Lip Balms collection:

The same grass-fed tallow that makes our balms exceptional for skin makes our lip balms exceptionally nourishing. No petroleum wax, no synthetic fragrance, no ingredients that sit on top of your lips rather than absorbing. Just deeply conditioning care in a format your lips can actually use.

Product Card Presentation

Each product card in the collection grid shows a product image, name, price, and a color or variant selector. Three small additions to the product card layout will lift click-through rates into individual product pages without requiring any significant code changes:

- Star rating below the product name: Even a small "4.9 ★ (127)" below the product title builds confidence before the click. Yotpo supports product card star ratings — check your Yotpo widget settings to enable this if it isn't already active.
- Subscribe & Save price callout: Show both the one-time price and the subscribe price on the card: "\$36 / one-time or \$30.60 / subscribe." Seeing the lower price before clicking the product page primes the visitor's price reference point favorably.

- **Hover zoom on product images:** On desktop, a subtle zoom of the product image when hovering signals that the image is clickable and the product is worth a closer look. This micro-interaction increases click-through rate from collection to product page.

Default Sort Order

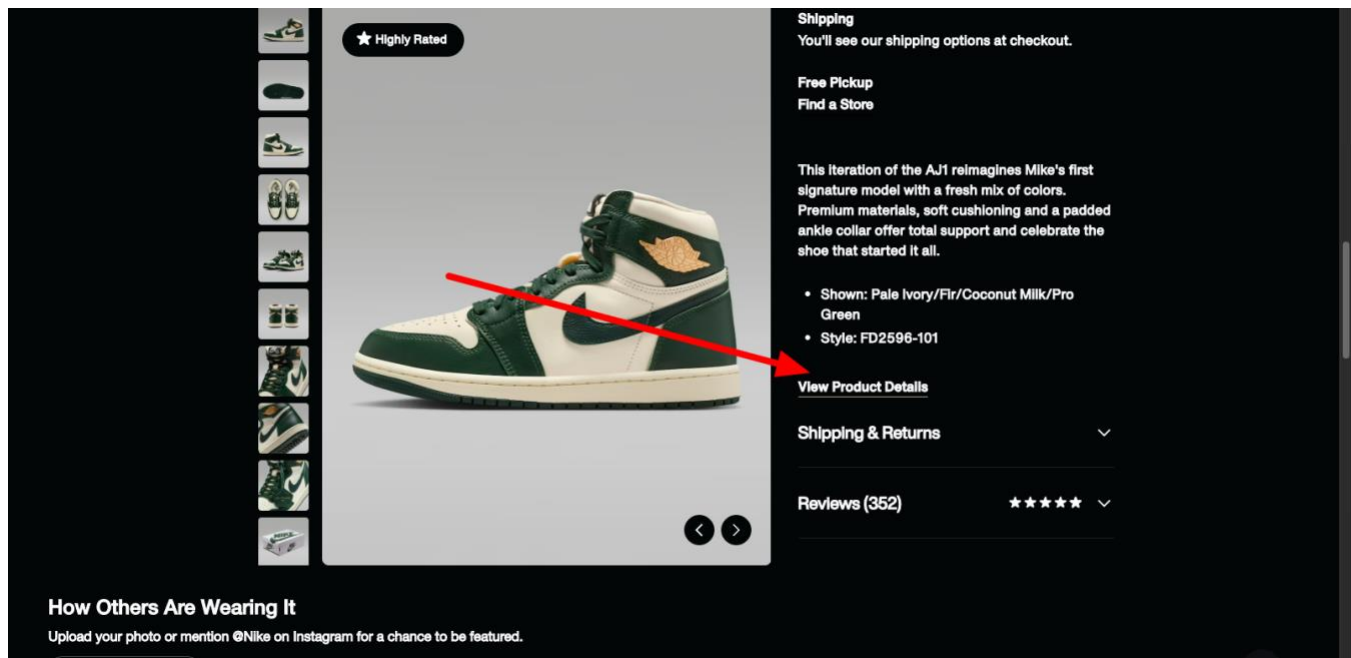
Set the default sort order for all collections to "Best Selling." This ensures that your strongest products — the ones with the most purchase history, the highest conversion rate, and (in the case of Yotpo) the most reviews — appear at the top of the grid for every new visitor. A visitor who lands on a collection and sees your best products first is more likely to click through than one who sees products in random or creation-date order

Desktop vs. Mobile Collection Layout

On desktop, a three-column product grid works well for most collection sizes and gives each product card enough room for a clear image, the product name, and the price. On mobile, use a two-column grid. A single-column grid on mobile requires significantly more scrolling to see the same number of products, and the increased scroll depth before seeing variety hurts engagement.

Make sure product card images are consistently cropped — same aspect ratio, same background treatment — across all products in a collection. Mismatched image crops make a grid look unprofessional even if the individual photos are high quality. If your product images are different sizes or aspect ratios, add a background crop in your theme settings to enforce consistency.

PRODUCT PAGE TEMPLATE



Example: high-converting product page CTA area — Subscribe & Save pre-selected, trust signals visible near the Add to Cart button

I'm going to walk through your product pages using the Tallow Balm — Original as the reference example throughout this section. Everything here — every recommendation, every piece of proposed copy, every structural change — applies to every product page on your store. The same template framework applies to your lip balms, your hair oil, your cold cream, and your nightgowns. You don't need to repeat this process product by product. Implement these changes once as a theme-level template and they roll out across every product automatically.

Subscribe & Save — Make It the Default, Not the Option

The single highest-impact change on your product pages is also one of the simplest to implement: pre-select the Subscribe & Save option and pre-select the two-unit quantity by default.

Right now, the one-time purchase is selected by default and Subscribe & Save is an alternative that requires active selection. The vast majority of visitors will make a purchase decision based on the default price they see — they don't toggle through options unless they have a specific reason to. Most customers who would happily subscribe never discover the option because it's presented as secondary and requires a deliberate action to choose.

When Subscribe & Save is pre-selected, the first price a visitor sees on the product page is \$30.60 (15% off \$36). That's their anchor. If they switch to one-time purchase, the price visibly increases — which is a powerful psychological nudge toward keeping the subscription. Customers who genuinely only want a one-time purchase still have that option; they just have to actively choose it rather than have it chosen for them.

Pre-selecting "Two Balms" as the default quantity at the same time brings the cart value to approximately \$61 with the subscription discount — just below your free shipping threshold and a dramatically higher average order value than a single-unit one-time purchase.

Implementation: this requires a small edit to your product page Liquid template to set the default selected variant and the default subscription radio button state. A Shopify developer can implement this in under one hour. It is directly, immediately revenue-generating — estimate a 15-25% increase in average order value on the first implementation week.

Important: implement this on the product page template level so it applies to every product. Don't implement it product by product.

Product Description — Restructure for How People Actually Read

Research on e-commerce reading behavior consistently shows that visitors scan product pages before they read them. They look at the headline, they look at the bullet points, they look at the price and the button — in that order. Only after they've decided they're interested do they go back and read the full description. Your current product descriptions are written as continuous prose, which serves the committed reader but loses the scanner.

The recommended structure for every product page description is: a bold benefit headline, one to two sentences of context, a short bullet list of the most important product attributes, and a single closing sentence that returns to the emotional benefit. This structure serves scanners (headline + bullets), readers (full paragraphs), and Google (keyword-rich prose content).

Proposed product description for Tallow Balm — Original using this structure:

HEADLINE: The only moisturizer your skin actually recognizes.

Made from 100% grass-fed beef tallow, this balm works with your skin's natural biology rather than fighting it. The fatty acid profile of grass-fed tallow is uniquely similar to your skin's own sebum — which is why it absorbs so effectively and why so many customers with dry, sensitive, or reactive skin find that it outperforms everything they've tried before.

- ✓ 100% grass-fed beef tallow — single ingredient, family farm sourced
- ✓ Face and body safe — gentle enough for your most sensitive areas
- ✓ Absorbs quickly with no greasy residue
- ✓ Fragrance-free and free of parabens, synthetics, and fillers
- ✓ Available in Original and herbed varieties
- ✓ Small-batch, made on the Mason family farm in Idaho

If you've tried every "natural" moisturizer on the market and nothing has stuck, this is where most of our customers start — and where most of them stay.

Move the Star Rating to the Top of the Page

Your Yotpo review section loads below the fold — visitors have to scroll past the product description, the ingredient section, and often several other content blocks to reach it. Yet the star rating and review count is one of the first things a hesitant customer wants to see. Most e-commerce best practices place a small clickable star rating directly under the product title, before the price, before the description, before anything else.

The implementation is straightforward: display the Yotpo star rating widget (just the stars + count, not the full review section) immediately below the product title in your product page template. When clicked, it should scroll or jump to the full reviews section lower on the page. This is Yotpo's standard "star widget" functionality and is available in your Yotpo settings without custom coding.

Trust Signals Below the Add to Cart Button

Directly below the Add to Cart button, add a small horizontal row of trust icons. These serve the same function as the homepage trust bar but at the conversion decision point — they catch the hesitant customer right at the moment of commitment. Recommended trust signals for the product page:

- Free returns on first order — reduces the perceived risk of a first purchase from a brand they don't know yet.
- Ships from the Mason family farm in Idaho — reinforces the provenance story and makes the transaction feel personal rather than transactional.
- 4.9 stars — 200+ verified reviews — specific, verifiable social proof at the exact right moment.
- Subscribe & Cancel anytime — addresses the #1 hesitation about subscriptions: the fear of being locked in.

Post-Purchase Upsell

A post-purchase upsell is one of the most efficient revenue drivers available in Shopify. It appears after the customer has completed their payment — on the order confirmation page or in a pop-up immediately after checkout — and offers a complementary product at a small discount with one-click add (no need to re-enter payment details). Take rates on well-targeted post-purchase offers typically run 8–25%.

The right upsell for someone who just bought the Tallow Balm is the Lip Balm or the Hair Oil — both are lower price points, naturally complementary, and solve adjacent problems for the same customer. The offer copy should be direct and low-pressure:

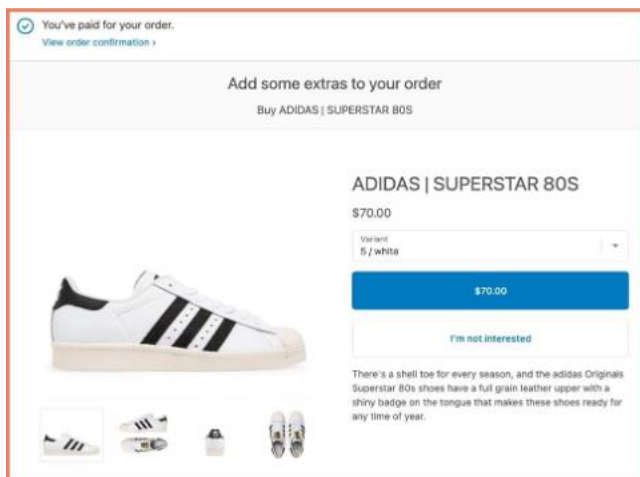
POST-PURCHASE OFFER COPY:

"Thank you, Richard! Your Tallow Balm is on its way.

One more thing — add our Tallow Lip Balm for 20% off. Same grass-fed formula, same clean ingredients, same results. One click — we already have your payment details on file."

[Button: Add the Lip Balm for \$X — one click] [No thanks, I'll skip this]

App recommendation: ReConvert Upsell & Cross Sell or Zipify One Click Upsell — both are available in the Shopify App Store, both integrate with Shopify's native checkout, no coding required.



Sticky Add to Cart on Mobile

On mobile, when a visitor scrolls past the buy box (the product image + purchase section at the top of the page), the Add to Cart button disappears and they're now reading product information with no purchase path visible. For visitors who are reading the description and getting more convinced, there's no immediate way to act on that conviction without scrolling all the way back up. A meaningful percentage of mobile visitors abandon at this point.

The fix is a sticky footer bar on mobile — a fixed element that stays at the bottom of the screen as the visitor scrolls, showing the product name, the current price, and a full-width Add to Cart button. When the buy box is visible in the viewport, the sticky bar hides to avoid duplication. When the buy box scrolls out of view, the bar appears.

Check your Shopify theme settings for a "Sticky Add to Cart" option first — many modern themes include this as a toggle. If yours doesn't, it's a common Shopify app feature available in apps like Sticky Add To Cart Booster Pro.

WHY TALLOW PAGE

Your Why Tallow page is one of the most strategically valuable pages on your site. It's the place where curious visitors — people who are interested in tallow skincare but don't fully understand it yet — come to get convinced. For the natural and clean beauty market, education drives purchase. A visitor who understands why grass-fed tallow is better than their current moisturizer is a customer. A visitor who doesn't understand that stays on the fence indefinitely.

The page currently delivers the right information but in a format that makes it harder to absorb than it needs to be. Two structural upgrades will make it significantly more effective as a conversion tool.

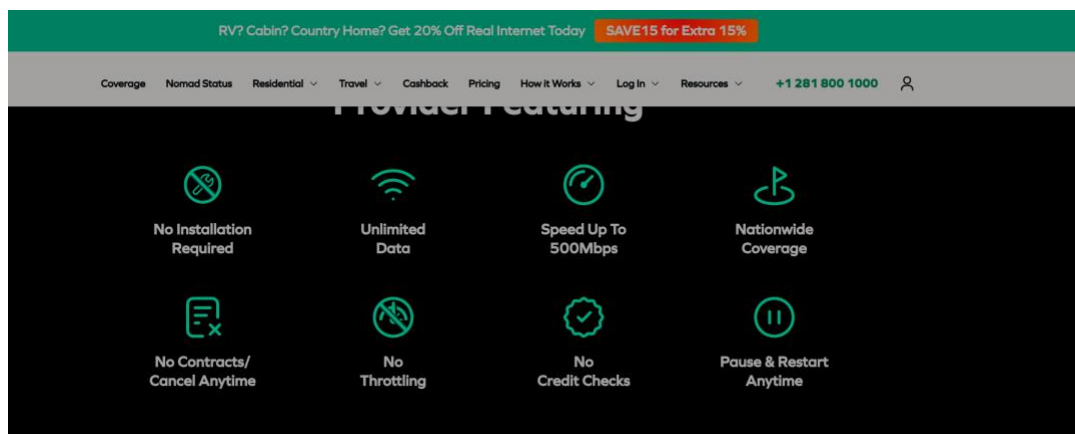
Add an Eight-Icon Benefit Grid at the Top

Before any explanatory text, before the first paragraph, add an eight-icon benefit grid at the top of the Why Tallow page. Eight icons arranged in two rows of four — each with a short bold label and one supporting sentence. This gives visitors who scan (which is most visitors) an immediate visual summary of the key benefits of tallow skincare before they decide whether to read further. It's the equivalent of a product overview card for the ingredient itself.

Here are the eight icons with their exact labels and supporting copy:

- Icon: grass or field — Label: "Grass-Fed" — Copy: Sourced from 100% grass-fed cattle so you get the full nutrient profile — higher in vitamins A, D, E, and K than grain-fed alternatives.
- Icon: crossed-out chemical symbol — Label: "No Fillers" — Copy: Every formula is clean-label. If you can't pronounce it and we can't trace it to a farm, it's not in here.
- Icon: water droplet absorbing into surface — Label: "Absorbs Fast" — Copy: Tallow's fatty acid profile closely matches your skin's natural sebum, so it absorbs without sitting on top or leaving a greasy layer.
- Icon: face and body silhouette — Label: "Face & Body" — Copy: Gentle enough for the most sensitive facial skin. Effective enough for your driest patches, cracked heels, and winter-damaged hands.
- Icon: barn or family silhouette — Label: "Family Farm" — Copy: Made in small batches on the Mason family farm in Idaho. Not outsourced, not mass-produced, not scaled beyond the point where quality is controlled.
- Icon: jar or long-lasting symbol — Label: "Long-Lasting" — Copy: One jar goes further than most conventional moisturizers. A little goes a long way because tallow is concentrated nutrition, not diluted water-based formula.
- Icon: ingredient list or leaf — Label: "Clean Label" — Copy: No parabens, no phthalates, no synthetic fragrances, no petroleum derivatives. What you see on the label is everything that's in the jar.
- Icon: five-pointed star with people — Label: "4.9 Stars" — Copy: Hundreds of verified reviews from real customers with real skin conditions — eczema, psoriasis, rosacea, dry skin, sensitive skin — who switched and stayed.

On desktop, the eight icons render in two rows of four columns across the full content width. On mobile, they collapse to a two-column layout with four rows. Keep icon art simple, line-based, and consistent in style — a clean set like Phosphor Icons or Feather Icons works well and is available free for commercial use.



Example: effective pain-point and education page layout that addresses objections and builds purchase confidence

Restructure Body Content — Headline, Intro, Bullets, Close

The current body content on the Why Tallow page is written in long prose paragraphs. The information is accurate and valuable, but the format requires a significant reading commitment before a visitor gets the key point. Most visitors won't make that commitment until they've already decided they're interested — which means the prose format is preaching to the choir and not converting the fence-sitters.

For every topic on the Why Tallow page, use this four-part structure: a bold headline that states the main point clearly, one to two sentences of context or setup, a three to five item bullet list of the supporting evidence or details, and a single closing sentence that brings it back to the customer's personal experience. This structure works for scanners, readers, and Google simultaneously.

Example — restructured "Why Tallow Works" section:

HEADLINE: Your skin is made to work with tallow.

INTRO: The fat composition of grass-fed beef tallow is remarkably similar to the fat composition of human skin. That's not a coincidence — it's why tallow has been used in skincare for thousands of years across cultures with no access to synthetic alternatives.

BULLETS:

- Contains oleic acid (the same omega-9 fatty acid that makes up 30% of your skin's own fat)
- Rich in stearic acid, which repairs the skin barrier and locks in moisture
- High in fat-soluble vitamins A, D, E, and K that support cell turnover and collagen production
- No water content means no need for the preservatives that irritate sensitive skin

CLOSE: If synthetic moisturizers have always felt like they were working against your skin instead of with it, that's not your skin being difficult — it's your skin being correct.

Use Accordions for Deep Scientific Content

The Why Tallow page includes detailed explanations of fatty acid profiles, bioavailability, lipid chemistry, and skin biology. This content is valuable — customers who want to understand the science deeply will read every word of it. But it creates a problem for customers who are just trying to decide if the product is right for them: the page feels long, dense, and technical, which triggers what conversion researchers call "information overload" and causes visitors to defer the decision rather than making it.

The solution is to move the detailed scientific content into accordions. Each accordion shows a clear headline — something like "The Science of Lipid Compatibility" or "Why Grass-Fed Tallow Has More Nutrients" — that's always visible. The detailed explanation is hidden behind a "Read more" expansion that visitors trigger on click. Customers who want the depth get it. Customers who just want to get to the buy decision aren't stopped by content they're not ready for.

Critically: content inside closed accordions is fully indexed by Google. The text is present in the HTML even when the accordion is visually collapsed. So you lose nothing from an SEO standpoint by collapsing deep content — the keywords are still there, just not visually overwhelming the page.

ABOUT US PAGE

Your About Us page tells the story of the Mason family farm and how White Sparrow Farmacy came to be. It's genuine, it's personal, and it's one of your strongest brand assets. Most skincare brands — especially at the scale of mass-produced "clean beauty" — don't have an origin story as authentic as yours. A real family, a real farm, a real reason for making these products from scratch. This page is doing important work for your brand.

There are two things missing that would significantly improve its contribution to conversion.

Missing: A Product CTA at the End

The About Us page currently ends the story and then... stops. The narrative builds warmth, connection, and trust. The visitor finishes reading and feels genuinely positive about the brand. And then there's nothing to do with that feeling except figure out their own way to the products.

This is a missed conversion moment. After someone has read your full origin story and connected emotionally with your brand, they are in the most receptive state of their entire site visit. They like you. They trust you. They want to do something about it. Leaving them without a clear next step means a portion of them will navigate away to figure it out themselves — and in that navigation gap, they can get distracted or lose momentum.

Add a CTA section at the very bottom of the About Us page. It doesn't need to be elaborate — a headline, one sentence, and a button:

HEADLINE: Ready to try it?

COPY: Everything we make starts on the farm and ends up on your skin. No shortcuts, no mystery ingredients, no middlemen.

[BUTTON: Shop Tallow Balms] [BUTTON: See All Products]

This is a two-minute addition in your Shopify page editor and it directly captures the conversion energy created by your story.

Add a Brand Summary Near the Top

For a first-time visitor who lands on the About Us page from a search result or a shared link, the page currently starts with the full story — which is the right move for visitors who are already engaged, but can feel like too much investment for visitors who aren't yet sure if they care. A short brand summary paragraph — four to five sentences — placed at the very top of the page before the full story gives these visitors a fast-entry version of who you are.

PROPOSED BRAND SUMMARY:

White Sparrow Farmacy is a family-run skincare brand based on the Mason farm in Idaho. We make 100% grass-fed tallow balms, lip balms, and body care products in small batches — with no synthetic additives, no fillers, and no ingredient lists that require a chemistry degree to decode.

Everything we sell, we make ourselves. Every batch is traceable to our own cattle. That's not a marketing claim — it's just how we've always done it.

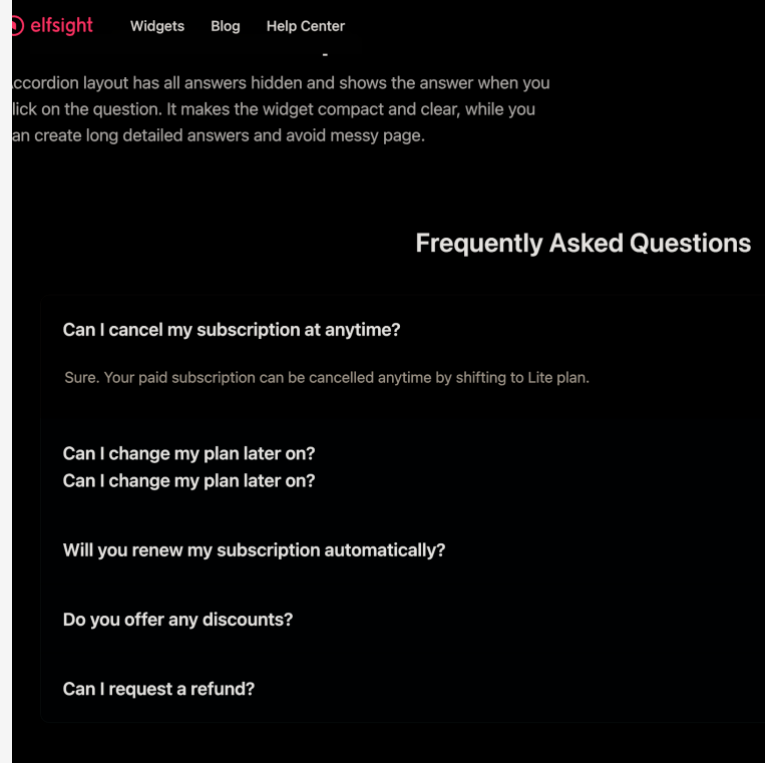
If you're new here, the tallow balm is where most people start.

Desktop vs. Mobile

The About Us page is primarily a reading experience, so the main design consideration is comfortable text presentation. On desktop, lifestyle photos of the farm and the family can sit alongside the text in a two-column layout — the visual variety breaks up long reading sections and keeps engagement high. On mobile, those photos should stack above the text blocks rather than running beside them (side-by-side on mobile creates text that's too narrow to read comfortably).

Ensure every farm and product photo on this page has descriptive alt text — not just "IMG_2847" but something like "Mason family farm in Idaho, where White Sparrow tallow products are made." This contributes to Google image search rankings for local and farm-related searches.

FAQ PAGE



Example: well-structured FAQ accordion — questions visible as collapsed headers, answers expand on click, naturally organized by topic

Your FAQ page contains genuinely useful answers to real customer questions about your tallow products. The content is solid. The two improvements I'm recommending are entirely structural — changing how the content is presented (accordion format) and adding a technical element that can get your FAQ answers appearing directly in Google Search results (FAQ schema markup).

Convert from List Format to Accordion Format

Right now, the FAQ page displays all questions and all answers fully expanded — every answer is visible whether the visitor wants to read it or not. On a page with ten or fifteen questions, this creates a very long, dense page that's hard to scan. Visitors who have one specific question have to scroll through every other question and answer to find it.

The accordion format solves this immediately. All questions are visible as collapsed headers — the visitor can see the full question list at a glance and knows exactly where to find what they're looking for. They click to expand the answer they want. The page is compact, scannable, and easy to navigate.

Beyond usability, this format is better for conversion. A visitor who can quickly find the answer to their specific question — "is this safe for my eczema?" — gets their objection resolved in seconds. A visitor who has to read through five unrelated answers before getting to theirs may give up before finding it.

How to implement: In your Shopify theme's page editor, look for a "Collapsible content" or "Accordion" section type when editing the FAQ page. Most modern Shopify themes include this

as a built-in section. If yours doesn't, the PageFly or Shogun page builder apps both handle accordions without coding.

After converting, test the page on mobile specifically — accordion navigation is especially valuable on phones where long-scroll pages are harder to use.

Add FAQ Schema Markup — Get Your Q&As in Google Search

FAQ schema is a piece of structured data code that you embed on your FAQ page. When Google reads it, your most important questions and answers can appear as an expanded list directly below your search result listing — a "rich result" that shows the questions in-line before a visitor even clicks. This dramatically increases the visual size of your listing in search results and significantly improves click-through rate for the keywords your FAQ covers.

This is particularly valuable for searches like "is tallow safe for sensitive skin," "what is grass-fed tallow balm," and "tallow balm vs regular moisturizer" — all high-intent queries where appearing with a rich result puts you ahead of every competitor who doesn't have schema markup.

Here is the exact schema markup code to add to your FAQ page. Add it as a custom HTML block at the bottom of the page, or have a developer add it to the FAQ page's liquid template file:

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "FAQPage",
  "mainEntity": [
    {
      "@type": "Question",
      "name": "Can you use tallow balm on both face and body?",
      "acceptedAnswer": { "@type": "Answer",
        "text": "Yes. Our tallow balms are formulated for both face and body use. The fatty acid profile of grass-fed tallow closely matches your skin's natural sebum, making it effective and gentle across all skin types and areas of the body — including the face, hands, elbows, and any areas of dryness or sensitivity." }
    },
    {
      "@type": "Question",
      "name": "Is tallow balm safe for sensitive skin?",
      "acceptedAnswer": { "@type": "Answer",
        "text": "Tallow balm is one of the most skin-compatible moisturizers available for sensitive skin. It contains no synthetic fragrances, no parabens, no preservatives, and no petroleum derivatives. Many customers with eczema, rosacea, psoriasis, and reactive skin find it gentler than conventional moisturizers precisely because it contains no synthetic additives that commonly trigger reactions." }
    },
    {
      "@type": "Question",
```

```
"name": "Where does your tallow come from?",
"acceptedAnswer": { "@type": "Answer",
  "text": "We source 100% grass-fed beef tallow from our own family farm in Idaho. It is
processed in small batches to preserve its natural nutrient profile, including fat-soluble
vitamins A, D, E, and K. We do not use commodity tallow or source from outside our own
farm." }
},
{
  "@type": "Question",
  "name": "How long does one jar of tallow balm last?",
  "acceptedAnswer": { "@type": "Answer",
    "text": "Most customers get 2-3 months of daily use from a single jar. Because tallow is a
concentrated formula with no water content, a small amount goes a long way — you need
significantly less than a typical water-based moisturizer to cover the same area." }
  }
]
}
```

</script>

Desktop vs. Mobile

The accordion format performs equally well on desktop and mobile. On mobile it is especially valuable — long scrolling pages of expanded FAQ content are nearly unusable on a phone. The collapsed accordion gives mobile users a clean, scrollable question list with instant access to individual answers. Test the FAQ page on a real phone after implementing the accordion to confirm the expand/collapse behavior works with a tap.

BLOG

Your blog has 30 published posts covering topics related to tallow skincare, clean beauty, farm life, and natural ingredients. Having a blog is the right strategic decision for a brand in your category — it gives Google more content to index, more keywords to rank for, and more opportunities to reach customers who are searching for information about natural skincare before they're ready to buy. A well-run blog is the most cost-effective long-term customer acquisition channel available to an independent Shopify store.

However, your blog has two specific problems that are actively limiting its performance and may be working against you. Both are fixable with no additional content creation required — just adjustments to how your existing content is structured and published.

Issue 1 — Thin Content: Your Posts Are Below Google's Quality Threshold

The majority of your blog posts are approximately 250 words long. Google's guidelines, reinforced heavily by the August 2024 Helpful Content update, treat content under approximately 600-800 words as "thin" — meaning it provides insufficient depth to demonstrate genuine expertise on a topic. Thin content pages rank poorly, if at all, in competitive search categories.

A 250-word blog post about "Why Tallow Is Better Than Shea Butter" is not going to rank on page one of Google for that search term. A 1,200-word post on the same topic — one that explains the fatty acid profiles of both ingredients, discusses bioavailability, addresses common skin types, includes real customer outcomes, and links to relevant products — can rank on page one and deliver consistent organic traffic for months or years at no additional cost.

The fix does not require creating new content. It requires expanding what you already have. Your existing 30 posts cover the right topics. They just don't cover them deeply enough to compete in search.

What to do: Open Google Search Console (search.google.com/search-console — it's free and should already be connected to your site). Look at Performance → Pages. Find your five highest-impression blog posts — the posts Google is showing in search results most often, even if click-through rate is low. Those are the posts worth expanding first.

Expand each from 250 words to a minimum of 1,200 words. Use this structure for each post:

1. A clear H1 headline that includes the primary keyword
2. An intro paragraph that states the topic and the reader's question
3. Three to five H2 subheadings with two to three paragraphs each
4. At least one bullet or numbered list within the post (good for scanners and for featured snippet eligibility)
5. A closing paragraph that connects back to your product with an internal link
6. One internal link to a relevant collection or product page in the body of the post

Do not publish new posts until these five are expanded. A smaller number of high-quality posts outperforms a large number of thin ones every time.

Issue 2 — Bulk Publishing Is a Google Spam Signal

Your 30 blog posts were published in approximately three batches over a short period of time — multiple posts published on the same day, in rapid succession, across three separate publishing events.

This specific pattern is one of the behaviors explicitly flagged by Google's Helpful Content update as a signal of AI-generated content spam: large volumes of new content appearing in bulk bursts, rather than accumulating organically over time.

To be absolutely clear: having blog content is not the problem. Publishing quality blog content is exactly what Google wants. The problem is the publishing pattern. Google expects a genuine human blogger to publish one to three posts per week consistently over months and years. When 30 posts appear in three batches across a short window, Google's systems treat it as a programmatic content flood — the same pattern used by low-quality sites that publish AI-generated articles at scale to try to game search rankings.

This may already be affecting your blog's search performance. It may explain why posts that should be ranking for relevant tallow skincare terms are not appearing in search results.

Fix: Backdate your existing posts to spread them across the past 6-12 months at a rate of one to two per week.

How to do it in Shopify: Go to Admin → Blog Posts → click on a post → scroll to the Visibility section on the right side → change the Published date to a date in the past. Assign dates that create a natural cadence — approximately one post per week spread across the past 6-12 months.

This takes approximately one hour to do for all 30 posts. Save each post after changing its date. The URLs stay the same; only the published date changes, which is what Google sees in its crawl.

Going forward: publish no more than one to two new blog posts per week. Consistency over time is what Google rewards. One new post per week for a year is worth far more than 52 posts published in a month.

High-Value Blog Topics for Long-Term SEO

Once the existing posts are expanded and the publishing pattern is corrected, these are the topics with the highest search volume and strongest alignment with your product that I'd recommend developing into full 1,200+ word posts:

- Tallow vs. shea butter: which is better for dry skin? — High search volume, clear winner for your brand, strong internal link opportunity to the Tallow Balm.
- What is grass-fed tallow and why does it matter for skincare? — Core educational content, high intent, drives directly to product pages.
- How to naturally moisturize eczema-prone skin — Very high search volume, strong customer match for your existing buyer profile.
- Why your moisturizer might be making your skin worse (and what to use instead) — Contrarian hook that performs well as shareable content and has strong conversion potential.
- Tallow skincare for beginners: what to expect in the first month — Post-purchase content that also attracts new prospects; supports SEO and email retention.
- The truth about "clean beauty" ingredients: what to look for and what to avoid — Brand authority content that positions White Sparrow in the clean beauty conversation.

CONTACT US PAGE

Your Contact Us page is clean and functional. It has a contact form and your support email address. For a brand at your stage, this is appropriate — you don't need a multi-channel support platform or a live chat system. Most of your customer contacts will be pre-purchase questions or post-purchase follow-ups, both of which are perfectly handled by a well-managed email inbox.

There are three small additions that will make the contact page work harder for both you and your customers.

Add a Link to the FAQ Page — Above the Form

The large majority of customer contacts for a skincare brand are pre-purchase questions: What's in it? Is it safe for my skin condition? How do I use it? How long does it last? What's your return policy? Almost all of these questions are answered on your FAQ page. But most customers who have a question don't think to check the FAQ first — they go straight to the contact form because that's their default behavior.

Adding a prominent line above the contact form — not a small footnote, but an actual paragraph — significantly reduces your incoming contact volume for basic questions while giving customers a faster path to their answer (the FAQ page) than email can provide.

PROPOSED COPY ABOVE THE CONTACT FORM:

Have a question about our products, ingredients, shipping, or returns? We've already answered the most common ones on our FAQ page — and you'll get your answer there faster than waiting for a reply from us.

[Link: Visit the FAQ page]

If your question isn't covered there, we'd love to hear from you. Fill out the form below and we'll get back to you within 1-2 business days.

Set a Clear Response Time Expectation

The line "we'll get back to you within 1-2 business days" in the proposed copy above serves a specific purpose: it removes the anxiety of sending a message into the unknown. When customers don't know when to expect a reply, some of them contact you multiple times about the same question, some of them assume you didn't receive their message and give up, and some of them make a purchase decision based on getting no answer rather than waiting for yours.

A clear response time expectation manages those expectations proactively. It tells the customer exactly what will happen after they hit submit. Even if you sometimes respond faster than 1-2 days, setting the expectation there means you'll rarely miss it — and exceeding an expectation always feels better than missing one.

Form UX — Small Improvements

A few quick checks on the contact form itself. First, make sure all field labels remain visible when the customer is typing in a field — some forms use placeholder text as the label, which disappears as soon

as the customer starts typing and leaves them guessing what information goes in which field. This is a particularly common frustration on mobile. Labels should be above the field, not inside it.

Second, the submit button should be clearly labeled. "Send Message" is better than "Submit" — it tells the customer what will happen when they click it rather than using generic form language.

Third, on mobile, the form should be a single full-width column. Multi-column forms on mobile screens create text fields that are too narrow to type in comfortably and too close to each other for thumb-tapping accuracy.

WHOLESALE PAGE

Your Wholesale page is something I need to call out clearly at the start of this section: it is currently completely broken. When you visit the Wholesale page on your live site, the background color is set to a near-black shade, making every text element effectively invisible. The page content exists — the text is there in the HTML — but it cannot be read because the text and the background are essentially the same color.

This is a critical issue. Any retailer, spa owner, boutique buyer, or wholesale prospect who visits this page sees a black screen and assumes the page is broken — or worse, that your brand doesn't take wholesale seriously enough to maintain a functioning web presence. Wholesale is a high-value revenue channel. One wholesale account can represent the revenue equivalent of dozens of direct-to-consumer sales. Sending prospective wholesale customers to a broken page is leaving significant money on the table.

URGENT FIX — The Black Background (5 Minutes)

The root cause of the black background is a background color setting in your Shopify theme editor that has been set to a near-black value rather than white or a light neutral. This is a theme customization issue, not a code issue. It requires no developer and takes approximately five minutes to fix.

STEP-BY-STEP FIX:

1. Log in to Shopify Admin
2. Go to Online Store → Themes → Customize
3. In the theme customizer, navigate to the Wholesale page (use the page selector at the top of the customizer)
4. Look for a Section or Background Color setting — it will be set to a dark or near-black color
5. Change it to white (#FFFFFF) or a light neutral (#F5F5F5)
6. Click Save
7. Open the Wholesale page in an incognito browser window to confirm it's now readable

If you can't find the color setting in the theme customizer, look for a Page Background Color setting in the global theme settings (the paint bucket icon in the bottom-left of the customizer).

This fix should take 5 minutes. Do this before anything else on this list.

Wholesale Page Content Strategy

Once the page is visible, the content itself needs to speak directly to the decision-maker at a retail buyer level. The people evaluating your brand for wholesale are experienced buyers who evaluate dozens of brands per month. Your page needs to answer their evaluation criteria quickly and specifically: what is the minimum order, what are the payment terms, what is the margin, how is shipping handled, and what makes your brand worth bringing into their store?

The current Wholesale page content is brief and doesn't fully answer these questions. Here's the copy I'd recommend building the page around:

HEADLINE: Carry White Sparrow Farmacy — Wholesale Information

We're a small-batch, 100% grass-fed tallow skincare brand based on a family farm in Idaho. Our products are clean-label, preservative-free, and designed for customers with sensitive, dry, or reactive skin who've tried conventional moisturizers and found them lacking.

We're currently available through Faire Marketplace (whitesparrow.faire.com) where you can place your first wholesale order with 50% off, free shipping for one year, and 60-day payment terms — the most flexible wholesale terms available in our category.

[CTA BUTTON: Order on Faire] [CTA BUTTON: Request a Line Sheet]

If you'd prefer to buy direct or have questions about our wholesale program, contact us at [email] or fill out the form below.

Faire Marketplace — Feature This Prominently

You are listed on Faire Marketplace — the largest wholesale marketplace for independent brands. This is a significant asset for wholesale customer acquisition. Faire handles the payment processing, the net-60 payment terms, the first-order discount, and the shipping fee structure. For a retailer who discovers you on Faire, the barrier to placing a first order is dramatically lower than placing a direct wholesale order with an unfamiliar brand.

Your first-order Faire terms are exceptional: 50% off the first order, free shipping for one year, and 60-day payment terms. These are the maximum benefits Faire offers and they're a genuine competitive advantage. A boutique or spa owner who's considering your brand versus another at a similar price point will find these terms significantly more favorable than a direct-order competitor who requires a minimum check and immediate payment.

Feature these terms explicitly on the Wholesale page. Don't make wholesale prospects dig through Faire's site to discover the terms — tell them right on your page:

FAIRE TERMS CALLOUT BOX:

Order your first White Sparrow shipment through Faire and get:

- ✓ 50% off your first order
- ✓ Free shipping for 1 year
- ✓ 60-day payment terms — pay after your customers do

These terms are applied automatically when you order through our Faire storefront. No code required, no negotiation needed.

[BUTTON: Visit Our Faire Storefront]

Wholesale Page SEO

Your Wholesale page title tag and meta description should be updated to include the relevant search terms that wholesale buyers actually use. Buyers looking for tallow skincare brands to carry in their

boutiques, spas, or health stores will search terms like "wholesale tallow balm" or "grass-fed tallow skincare wholesale." Your Wholesale page is currently not optimized for these terms.

Suggested page title: "Wholesale Grass-Fed Tallow Skincare — White Sparrow Farmacy" — includes the most important search terms and the brand name.

Suggested meta description: "Carry White Sparrow Farmacy in your store. 100% grass-fed tallow skincare, made in Idaho. Available on Faire with 50% off first order, free shipping, and 60-day terms." — answers the most important wholesale buyer questions in under 160 characters.

COLOR, TYPOGRAPHY & ACCESSIBILITY

Accessibility is not just an ethical consideration — it directly affects your conversion rate. Text that's hard to read gets skimmed or skipped. Buttons that are hard to see don't get clicked. Elements that don't have enough contrast between the text color and background color fail WCAG accessibility guidelines, which means they will fail to load or display correctly for a percentage of your visitors who use accessibility tools or assistive settings on their devices.

Beyond that practical conversion impact, Google uses accessibility signals as part of its site quality assessment. A site that scores poorly on accessibility metrics (which Google measures through its Lighthouse tool) receives modest but real search ranking penalties. Fixing the contrast issues I've identified below improves both your conversion rate and your SEO health simultaneously.

Hero Section — Text Overlay Contrast

The hero section on your homepage places white text directly over a full-width lifestyle photography background. The light areas of the photo — bright sky, light-colored surfaces, pale backgrounds in the image — create text contrast ratios that drop below the 4.5:1 minimum required by WCAG AA (the standard required for commercial websites).

The fix is adding a dark overlay between the image and the text. A semi-transparent dark layer — typically a black or dark brown layer set to 30-40% opacity — sits behind the text and in front of the photo, creating a consistently dark background for the white text without obscuring the photography. This is standard practice on lifestyle-photo websites and is used by virtually every large e-commerce brand that uses photography-based hero sections.

CSS for the overlay (add to your theme's custom CSS):

```
.hero-media::after {  
  content: "";  
  position: absolute;  
  inset: 0;  
  background: rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.35);  
  z-index: 1;  
}  
.hero-content { position: relative; z-index: 2; }
```

Your developer can implement this in 10 minutes. The exact class names may differ depending on your theme — ask your developer to match the overlay to your hero section's CSS structure.

Body Text Size — Mobile Minimum

Your site's body text appears to be set at approximately 14px in certain sections on mobile. The minimum comfortable reading size for body text on a mobile screen is 16px. Text at 14px requires visitors to zoom in on their phone to read comfortably — most won't, they'll just skip that content or leave.

Check your theme settings for base font size and ensure body text is set to a minimum of 16px globally. In your theme's CSS, look for font-size declarations on body, p, or .body-text selectors and adjust

accordingly. This is a global CSS change that takes under five minutes but improves the reading experience across every page on the site.

Button Contrast and Click Target Size

Your CTA buttons (Shop Now, Add to Cart, Subscribe & Save) use a color scheme that renders well on desktop at full viewport width. However, check each button's contrast ratio — you can use the free WebAIM Contrast Checker tool (webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker) to test. Enter the background color of the button and the color of the button text and confirm the contrast ratio is above 4.5:1. If it falls below this threshold, adjust either the button background or the text color.

On mobile, all clickable buttons should be a minimum of 44x44 pixels — this is the Apple Human Interface Guidelines minimum for touch targets. A button that's 30px tall on mobile will require visitors to tap with precision rather than with a natural thumb movement. Every time a visitor has to tap a button twice because they missed it the first time, there's a chance they give up instead of trying again.

PERFORMANCE, TRACKING & ANALYTICS

This section covers the technical infrastructure that underlies everything else in this audit. You can implement every conversion optimization I've recommended — better copy, a fixed navigation, pre-selected subscription defaults, improved product descriptions — and still be working blind if your tracking setup is incomplete. Without reliable data on what's working, you're making marketing decisions on instinct rather than evidence. And in a paid advertising environment specifically, faulty tracking is directly expensive: every dollar spent on ads that aren't being accurately attributed is a dollar you can't optimize.

Meta Pixel — Are You Capturing All Your Conversions?

Your Meta Pixel is installed, which means Facebook and Instagram ads are receiving purchase signals from your store. However, if you're not running the Conversions API (CAPI) alongside the pixel, you're likely missing 20-40% of your actual conversion events due to iOS 14+ privacy restrictions.

When Apple introduced App Tracking Transparency in iOS 14, it gave iPhone users the ability to block cross-site tracking. A large percentage of iPhone users opted out of tracking — and iPhone users represent a significant portion of fashion, beauty, and lifestyle e-commerce buyers. When those users opt out, the browser-based Meta Pixel can't track their purchases. Facebook sees the ad click but not the resulting purchase, so that conversion is never attributed back to your ad. Facebook's optimization algorithms then have incomplete data and can't effectively identify who else to show your ads to.

The Conversions API solves this by sending purchase events from your server directly to Facebook, bypassing the browser-based tracking restriction entirely. When a customer completes a purchase, your Shopify server sends the purchase data directly to Meta's servers — regardless of the customer's tracking preferences. The event is still anonymized and privacy-compliant, but it's no longer blocked by iOS.

The fastest implementation for Shopify is Stape — a Conversions API management platform that connects to both Shopify and Meta with no custom coding required. Stape has a Shopify app and a straightforward setup wizard that most store owners can complete in under one hour without a developer.

After setup, open Facebook Events Manager and compare your browser pixel event counts against your server event counts for the same time period. The difference is the volume of conversions you were previously missing — and it directly tells you how much your ad performance has been understated.

Google Analytics 4 — Basic Setup Verification

Confirm that Google Analytics 4 is installed and tracking correctly on your store. In GA4, go to Reports → Realtime and then visit your own store in a separate browser window. You should see yourself appear in the Realtime report within 30 seconds. If you don't, GA4 is either not installed or not tracking correctly.

Also verify that purchase events are being recorded. In GA4, go to Reports → Monetization → Overview. If you see purchase revenue figures that match your Shopify order history, tracking is working. If you see no data or dramatically underreported figures, there's a tracking gap that needs to be closed before any ad performance analysis is meaningful.

The Shopify-GA4 integration is available through the Google & YouTube app in the Shopify App Store. It's a native integration that doesn't require manual code installation and should take under 30 minutes to configure.

Microsoft Clarity — Free Heatmap and Session Recording

Microsoft Clarity is a free behavioral analytics tool that shows you exactly how visitors interact with your site. It records anonymous session videos (you see the mouse movements, clicks, and scrolling behavior of real visitors without capturing any personal information), generates heatmaps that show where clicks are concentrated on each page, and flags "rage click" events where visitors are repeatedly clicking on something that isn't responding.

Install Clarity on your Shopify store now and let it run for two to four weeks. At the end of that period, review the session recordings for your highest-traffic pages (Homepage, Product Page, Collection Page) and the heatmaps for those pages. The patterns you'll see — where visitors are spending their time, what they're clicking on, where they're stopping scrolling — are worth more than any recommendation in this audit for guiding your next round of optimization decisions. Clarity is free, the Shopify installation is a simple code snippet add, and the data it generates is immediately actionable.

Site Speed — Check Your Core Web Vitals

Google's Core Web Vitals (CWV) are three page loading performance metrics that Google uses directly as ranking signals. They measure how fast your page loads (Largest Contentful Paint), how quickly it responds to interaction (First Input Delay / Interaction to Next Paint), and how stable the layout is during loading (Cumulative Layout Shift). Stores that score "Good" on all three metrics rank better in Google Search and have lower bounce rates from mobile visitors than stores that score "Needs Improvement."

Run a free CWV audit by going to pagespeed.insights.com and entering your homepage URL. Run it twice — once for Mobile and once for Desktop. If your mobile score is below 60, there are meaningful speed improvements needed and the specific bottlenecks will be listed in the report. The most common causes of slow Shopify stores are unoptimized images (large file sizes), too many installed apps loading JavaScript, and large video files in the hero section.

Quick wins for page speed:

1. Convert all product and blog images to WebP format (smaller file size, same quality) — the TinyIMG app handles this automatically for Shopify.
2. Audit your installed apps. Every app you've installed but aren't actively using is still loading JavaScript on your storefront and slowing your pages. Uninstall any app that isn't providing active value.
3. If you have any autoplay videos in the hero or elsewhere, ensure they're not the full uncompressed video file — compress to under 5MB or use a Vimeo/YouTube embed instead of a native Shopify video file.
4. Enable lazy loading for images below the fold — most modern Shopify themes do this by default, but confirm it's active in your theme settings.

META ADS STRATEGY

Meta advertising (Facebook and Instagram) is the most powerful paid customer acquisition channel available to a DTC brand at your stage. When it's set up well, it compounds: a good ad generates purchases, those purchases feed purchase data back to Facebook, Facebook uses that data to find more people like your buyers, and the audience targeting gets more precise over time. But when the foundation is wrong — faulty tracking, generic creative, no landing page, or ad budget spread too thin — it burns money without building anything.

This section covers exactly how to set up your Meta advertising foundation so that every dollar you spend is building a data asset, not just buying a single click. Everything I'm recommending here is based on current Meta best practices for DTC skincare brands and directly addresses the specific situation of your product: a premium-priced, education-required purchase in a skeptical market.

Campaign Structure — Three-Tier Funnel

Organize your Meta campaigns into three tiers that correspond to where potential customers are in their awareness of your brand. This structure ensures you're spending the right message on the right person at the right time — and not running awareness ads to people who are already ready to buy, or retargeting people who've never heard of you.

- **TOP OF FUNNEL (TOF) — Cold Audience Education:** These ads run to people who have never heard of White Sparrow Farmacy and may not know what tallow skincare is. The goal is not to get a purchase on the first click — the goal is to earn a website visit, a video view, or a profile follow. Educational content performs best here: a 30-60 second video explaining what tallow is and why it works, a carousel showing the farm and the product-making process, or a lifestyle image with copy that addresses the most common "natural skincare" search intent. Audience targeting for TOF should be interest-based: skincare, natural beauty, clean beauty, eczema, sensitive skin, organic products.
- **MIDDLE OF FUNNEL (MOF) — Warm Audience Nurturing:** These ads run to people who have already interacted with your brand — visited your website, watched 50%+ of a TOF video, followed your Instagram account, or engaged with a previous ad. They know who you are but haven't bought yet. MOF ads can be more product-specific: "still thinking about the tallow balm?" style copy, a customer testimonial video, a side-by-side comparison with conventional moisturizers, or a "here's what makes our balm different" education ad. Audience targeting: Website Visitors (last 30 days), Video Viewers (50%+), Instagram Engagers (last 60 days).
- **BOTTOM OF FUNNEL (BOF) — Purchase Conversion:** These ads run to people who have visited the product page or added to cart but not purchased. They're warm, they're interested, and they need one final nudge. BOF ads should be direct and remove the last hesitation: a specific offer ("Subscribe & Save 15% on your first order"), a strong testimonial that addresses the exact hesitation holding them back (sensitive skin, "does this actually work"), or a time-limited free shipping incentive. Audience targeting: Product Page Visitors (last 7 days), Add to Cart (last 7 days).

Creative Strategy — What to Test First

For a brand in the natural skincare category, three creative formats consistently outperform others on Meta: customer testimonial videos, product demonstration videos, and founder or farm story content. Here's how to approach each:

- **CUSTOMER TESTIMONIAL VIDEO** (strongest converter for BOF): A real customer, on camera, in their own words, describing the specific problem they had before (eczema, dry skin, reactive skin) and what changed after using the product. 30-60 seconds. No professional production required — iPhone quality filmed with decent lighting is often more credible than polished production because it signals authenticity. Ask your best customers if they'd be willing to film a short video in exchange for free product.
- **PRODUCT DEMONSTRATION** (strongest for TOF/MOF): A close-up video of the balm being applied to skin — the texture, the absorption, how it melts on contact with skin warmth. Voiceover explains what makes it different from a conventional moisturizer. 15-30 seconds. This ad answers the implicit question "but what does it actually do?" that every first-time tallow customer has.
- **FARM STORY / FOUNDER CONTENT** (strongest for brand trust): A short video shot on the Mason family farm. The cattle in the background, the kitchen or production space, Richard or a family member speaking directly to camera about why they started making these products. This is your brand's most unique differentiator — no competitor has your specific story. A 60-second farm origin video can perform as both TOF creative and as branded content that drives organic engagement.

Dedicated Landing Pages — Not Your Homepage

One of the most important structural decisions in your Meta ads setup is where paid traffic lands. Sending ad traffic to your homepage is the default and it's the wrong default for most brands. Your homepage is designed for everyone — organic visitors, direct traffic, returning customers. It has multiple navigation options, multiple product categories, and a general brand message. A paid traffic visitor who clicked a specific ad about tallow for sensitive skin is not "everyone" — they responded to a specific message and they expect that message to continue when they arrive.

Dedicated landing pages for paid traffic — pages that are stripped of the main navigation, focused on a single product, and built to match the specific ad they came from — consistently convert at 2-4x the rate of homepage traffic for cold paid audiences. The investment is a one-time setup effort that pays dividends across every campaign you run thereafter.

Minimum landing page setup for your Meta campaigns:

LANDING PAGE 1 — Sensitive Skin / Eczema Angle:

Headline: "Finally — a moisturizer that doesn't break you out."

Target: TOF and MOF audiences with sensitive skin, eczema, rosacea interest targeting

CTA: Subscribe & Save 15% on the Tallow Balm

LANDING PAGE 2 — Grass-Fed / Clean Beauty Angle:

Headline: "One ingredient you can actually pronounce."

Target: clean beauty, natural skincare, organic products interest audiences

CTA: Shop the Tallow Balm

LANDING PAGE 3 — Problem-Solution (replace your moisturizer) Angle:

Headline: "What if your moisturizer is actually making your skin worse?"

Target: broad interest skincare audiences for TOF cold traffic

CTA: Try Tallow Balm — No Synthetic Ingredients

Each landing page removes the main site navigation, has a single CTA, includes the best testimonial for that specific angle, and matches the exact copy and visual language of the ad it corresponds to. Shopify page builders like PageFly or Shogun make building these pages straightforward without a developer.

Budget Guidance — Where to Start

For a brand that is new to or scaling Meta advertising, the recommended starting structure is spending 60% of your daily budget on TOF (cold audience, education and awareness), 25% on MOF (warm audience, nurturing), and 15% on BOF (retargeting, conversion). This ratio ensures you're constantly filling the top of your funnel with new aware prospects while converting the warm audience you've already built.

Start with a daily budget of \$30-50 per campaign to gather meaningful data. Don't adjust the creative or audience within the first 7 days — Meta needs enough conversion data to exit the Learning Phase before you optimize. After 7-10 days, look at your Cost Per Purchase for each ad set and pause the ones where Cost Per Purchase exceeds your customer lifetime value. Scale the budget 15-20% every 4-5 days on the ads that are performing.

30 / 60 / 90-DAY ACTION PLAN

Every recommendation in this audit has been prioritized and organized into a three-phase action plan. The phases are sequenced so that the highest-impact, lowest-effort changes happen first and generate momentum and data to guide the more complex work in later phases. You don't need to implement everything at once. You need to implement the right things in the right order.

Where an item says "No developer required," it can be completed in your Shopify Admin or theme customizer by anyone with admin access. Where it says "Developer: [time estimate]," it requires a theme code change or app configuration that's beyond the settings interface — but none of them are major development projects. Almost everything in this audit is under 2 hours of developer time per item.

Days 1–30: Fix What's Broken, Add What's Missing

In the first 30 days, focus entirely on fixes that remove friction and revenue leaks. These are the items that are either broken (the Wholesale page, wrong navigation URLs) or that are directly costing you money every day they're not in place (Subscribe & Save defaulting, the free shipping threshold gap, the Conversions API gap). Do not skip to the creative or content items in Phase 2 until these are done — they have the highest return per hour of implementation time.

- DAY 1: Fix the Wholesale page black background. [No developer required — 5 minutes in Shopify theme customizer]
- DAY 1: Fix all incorrect navigation links. [No developer required — 15 minutes in Shopify Admin → Navigation → Main Menu]
- DAY 2–3: Change navigation dropdown from click to hover (desktop) and accordion (mobile). [Developer: 30 minutes]
- DAY 3–4: Pre-select Subscribe & Save and Two-Pack quantity as defaults on all product pages. [Developer: 1 hour]
- DAY 5–7: Install Microsoft Clarity for session recordings and heatmaps. [No developer required — 15 minutes to install app and add tracking code snippet]
- DAY 7–10: Set up Meta Conversions API via Stape. [No developer required — 1-2 hours to configure]
- DAY 10–14: Add trust bar to homepage hero. [Developer: 1 hour or theme section addition in customizer]
- DAY 14–20: Add product description restructure (Headline, Bullets, Close) to all product pages. [No developer required — edit in product description fields in Shopify Admin]
- DAY 20–25: Enable breadcrumb navigation sitewide. [No developer required if theme supports toggle, or Developer: 30 minutes]
- DAY 25–30: Backdate blog posts to spread over past 6-12 months. [No developer required — 1 hour in Shopify Admin → Blog Posts]

Days 31–60: Add Structure and Depth

In the second 30 days, build out the structural improvements that turn your store from a functional Shopify site into an optimized conversion machine. These changes require more time to implement but deliver compounding results — a stronger FAQ page benefits SEO and conversion simultaneously for years.

- DAY 31–35: Launch mega menu via Globo or Qikify. [No developer required — app install plus visual editor setup, approximately 3-4 hours]
- DAY 35–40: Move Yotpo star rating widget to directly below product title on all product pages. [Developer: 45 minutes]
- DAY 40–45: Convert FAQ page to accordion format and add FAQ schema markup. [Developer: 1 hour, or no developer if using a page builder app]
- DAY 40–50: Expand top 5 blog posts from ~250 words to 1,200+ words using the Headline/Intro/Bullets/Close structure. [No developer required — content editing in Shopify Admin, budget 2-3 hours per post]
- DAY 45–50: Add benefit icon grid to homepage between hero and featured products. [Developer: 2 hours]
- DAY 50–55: Add post-purchase upsell app (ReConvert or Zipify). [No developer required — app install plus offer configuration, approximately 2 hours]
- DAY 55–60: Add sticky Add to Cart bar on mobile product pages. [No developer required if theme supports it, otherwise Developer: 1 hour]

Days 61–90: Scale What Works

In the third 30 days, apply the data you've gathered from Microsoft Clarity, your Shopify analytics, and your Meta Ads Manager to focus your attention on the highest-impact areas. By this point, you'll have 60 days of post-improvement data. Some changes will show immediate lift in conversion rate. Some will need further refinement. Use what you know to decide what to double down on and what to adjust.

- DAY 61–65: Build three Meta advertising landing pages (Sensitive Skin angle, Clean Beauty angle, Problem-Solution angle) using PageFly or Shogun. [Developer: 3-4 hours total, or no-code page builder]
- DAY 65–70: Launch TOF Meta ad campaign using farm story or product demonstration video creative. Start with \$30-50/day. [Marketing time: 3-4 hours to set up, then daily 15-minute review]
- DAY 70–75: Launch BOF retargeting campaign to Product Page Visitors and Add to Cart visitors. [Marketing time: 2 hours]
- DAY 75–80: Review Microsoft Clarity heatmaps and session recordings for Homepage, Product Page, and Collection Page. Document top 3 observations. Implement quick fixes based on what you see. [No developer required for analysis; developer time depends on findings]
- DAY 80–85: Add Why Tallow page benefit icon grid and restructure to accordion format for detailed science content. [Developer: 2-3 hours]
- DAY 85–90: Audit all remaining blog posts and expand the next five highest-impression posts. Publish the additional high-value blog topics identified in the Blog section. [Content editing: 2-3 hours per post]

What Success Looks Like

By the end of 90 days, if you've implemented the Phase 1 and Phase 2 items, you should expect to see measurable improvement in three specific metrics. Your average order value should be higher — primarily driven by the Subscribe & Save pre-selection and the two-pack default. Your email and subscription conversion rate should be higher because the Subscribe & Save option is now the path of least resistance rather than the opt-in. And your Meta ad attribution should be more complete because the Conversions API is now recovering the iOS-blocked purchase signals that were previously invisible.

The Phase 3 items — landing pages, Meta campaigns, additional blog content — are the compounding investments. They take longer to show results but they're building assets that appreciate over time. A well-performing Meta ad creative can run profitably for months. A 1,200-word blog post targeting "tallow balm for eczema" can deliver organic traffic for years. The work you do in days 61–90 is the foundation of your brand's long-term customer acquisition infrastructure.

If you hit a point where you're not sure what to prioritize next, come back to your data. Check your Shopify conversion rate (the percentage of sessions that result in a purchase). Check your Microsoft Clarity recordings for where visitors are dropping off. Check your Meta Ads Manager for which ad sets have the lowest cost per purchase. The answer to "what should I do next?" is almost always visible in your analytics — you just need to know what you're looking for.